ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR HOSPITALITY AND TOURISM

Hospitality & Tourism English

Welcome warmly. Resolve clearly. Coordinate precisely.



Phil Stilwell

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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation, page 4

Acknowledge an expectation gap and give a reliable next step without inventing a room-ready time.

02 Complaint Handling and Online Reviews, page 14

Acknowledge a complaint, protect booking details, and move investigation to the appropriate private channel.

03 Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks, page 28

Present verified alternatives, explain differences honestly, and obtain a guest decision before changing the booking.

04 Revenue Management and Pricing, page 39

Explain occupancy, average daily rate, and revenue per available room using the correct denominators.

05 Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover, page 53

Read back separate department statuses and keep a room unavailable until the required release is recorded.

06 Events, Banquets, and Run of Show, page 64

Turn an assumed event arrangement into a timed, owned, and acknowledged schedule entry.

07 Tour Operations and Traveler Safety, page 76

Communicate an active tour hold, identify decision authority, and give an update without promising departure.

08 Cultural Expectations and Service Style, page 87

Clarify an individual service preference, limit its scope, and distinguish a request from a confirmed arrangement.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Hospitality without uncertain promises

Good service combines warmth with accurate information. Say what is confirmed, explain the available options, and take responsibility for the next communication. Keep internal shorthand out of guest-facing explanations.

Acknowledge before correcting

Recognize the inconvenience, then explain the relevant facts. An explanation that starts by blaming the guest can make a solvable problem harder to resolve.
"I can see why that message suggested the room would be ready. Let me clarify what we can confirm."

Promise the action you control

A check with another department and a guest update are actions you can own. A repair completion, room release, or tour departure may depend on a separate decision.
"I will update you at one o'clock, even if the room is still awaiting release."

Translate operational language

Terms such as walk, release, and room inventory have specialist meanings. Use them precisely with colleagues and explain the practical outcome to guests.
"We can arrange the confirmed room at the nearby hotel, with the agreed transfer included."

Ask about the individual

A preference about timing, beds, conversation, or service frequency belongs to the guest. Nationality does not establish the reason or the preferred response.
"Would you prefer service after two today, or no service today?"

Professional boundaries

All properties, people, figures, and policies in the cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace language, not legal advice or safety procedures. Follow current local rules, approved service policies, privacy requirements, and operator emergency plans. Do not treat an exercise as operational authorization.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / GUEST ARRIVAL AND FRONT-DESK ESCALATION

Acknowledge an expectation gap and give a reliable next step without inventing a room-ready time.

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

Ms Vega arrives at 12:15. Her confirmation says that her early-arrival request has been noted, but she understood this as guaranteed access at noon. Standard check-in begins at 15:00. No room has yet been released, and the front desk has no verified room-ready time. Complimentary luggage storage and use of the lobby seating are available now. Front-desk agent Arun can check with housekeeping and give a personal update at 13:00 even if the status has not changed. He cannot guarantee an earlier room or authorize compensation on his own.

People: Arun, Front-desk agent; Ms Vega, Arriving guest.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What did the confirmation establish?

A. The early-arrival request was recorded.
B. A room was guaranteed at noon.
C. The guest had canceled her booking.
D. Compensation had been approved.

2. What can Arun provide now?

A. A guaranteed 13:00 room
B. Complimentary luggage storage and lobby seating
C. A released room
D. An approved refund

3. What does the 13:00 commitment concern?

A. The start of standard check-in
B. A personal status update
C. Guaranteed room entry
D. Completion of every room inspection

Answers and explanations, page 113

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

early arrival
Arrival before the standard check-in period.

note an early arrival

early check-in
Access to a room before the usual check-in time.

request early check-in

reservation confirmation
A message documenting a booking and its stated terms.

review the reservation confirmation

special request
A preference or need submitted with a booking.

record a special request

guaranteed access
A confirmed commitment that entry will be available.

distinguish guaranteed access

subject to availability
Dependent on whether the requested service is available.

explain subject to availability

front desk
The guest reception and service point.

contact the front desk

guest relations
The function handling guest experience and concerns.

refer to guest relations

duty manager
The manager responsible during a particular shift.

consult the duty manager

arrival time
The time a guest reaches the property.

confirm the arrival time

check-in window
The stated period when check-in begins or is expected.

clarify the check-in window

room assignment
Allocation of a particular room to a booking.

confirm a room assignment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

early arrival EARLY ARRIVAL

note an early arrival

Keep the meaning precise: Arrival before the standard check-in period.

subject to availability SUBJECT TO AVAILABILITY

explain subject to availability

Keep the meaning precise: Dependent on whether the requested service is available.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

room-ready time
The time a room is expected or confirmed to be available.
verify the room-ready time

room release
Authorization to make a prepared room available for use.
await room release

luggage storage
A service holding bags before or after room use.
offer luggage storage

claim ticket
A receipt used to identify stored belongings.
issue a claim ticket

complimentary
Supplied without an additional charge.
offer a complimentary service

lobby
The main public reception area.
use the lobby seating

status update
A report on the current position of a request.
provide a status update

expectation gap
A difference between anticipated and actual service.
acknowledge an expectation gap

service recovery
Action to address a disappointing service experience.
coordinate service recovery

authorization limit
The boundary of what an employee may approve.
respect an authorization limit

escalation
Referral to a person with relevant responsibility or authority.
explain the escalation

follow-through
Completion of an action that was promised.
ensure reliable follow-through

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

room assignment ROOM ASSIGNMENT

confirm a room assignment

Keep the meaning precise: Allocation of a particular room to a booking.

complimentary COMPLIMENTARY

offer a complimentary service

Keep the meaning precise: Supplied without an additional charge.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the impact

I understand that you planned around arriving at noon.

Clarify the record

The message records your request for early access.

State the current position

No room has been released yet.

Offer immediate help

We can store your luggage at no additional charge.

Take the next action

I will check the status with housekeeping.

Preserve the distinction

That is an update time, not a promise of room access.

Avoid passing blame

Let me clarify the wording and the available options.

Check the guest's preference

Would you like us to store your bags now?

Own unclear wording

I am sorry the confirmation did not make that distinction clear.

Separate confirmation

It does not confirm that a room is ready at noon.

Avoid an invented estimate

I do not have a verified room-ready time.

Offer a place to wait

You are welcome to use the lobby seating.

Set the update time

I will speak with you again at 13:00.

Explain the normal timing

Standard check-in begins at 15:00.

Respect approval limits

A compensation request needs the duty manager's review.

Close the loop

I will update you even if the status has not changed.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Separate confirmation
Useful wording: It does not confirm that a room is ready at noon.

Purpose: State the current position
Useful wording: No room has been released yet.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which reply handles the misunderstanding best?

A. I see why you expected noon access; the request was recorded, but no room is released yet.
B. You should have understood the wording.
C. Your room will certainly be ready in ten minutes.
D. Housekeeping always causes this problem.

2. Which promise is within Arun's stated control?

A. The room will be ready at 13:00.
B. I guarantee an upgrade.
C. I have approved a refund.
D. I will update you at 13:00 even if we are still waiting.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A preference or need submitted with a booking. Which term fits?

A. special request
B. luggage storage
C. duty manager
D. service recovery

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An early-arrival request sounded like a promise". Ms Vega: "Is there no possibility of a room before three? Should I leave and return later?" Arun: [missing response] Ms Vega: "Another hotel promised twenty minutes, and I waited nearly two hours. I would prefer an honest answer to another guess." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will give you a personal status update at one o'clock. That update will happen even if we are still waiting. One o'clock is not a confirmed time for entering the room.

B. You can come back to me at the front desk. I will coordinate the check with housekeeping and tell you the result, so you do not need to repeat the request elsewhere.

C. That is reasonable. I can offer complimentary luggage storage now, and you may use the lobby seating. I will also check directly with housekeeping rather than leave your request without a follow-up.

D. I cannot rule out earlier availability, but I do not have a verified room-ready time. No room has been released yet, so I should not give you an estimate as a promise.

Answers and explanations, page 113

One useful distinction

The recorded request is not a confirmed noon check-in. The 13:00 update is a communication commitment, not a room-release estimate. Standard check-in begins at 15:00; Arun should not invent a different guaranteed time.

E Conversation

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

frustration / status update / follow-through / front desk / claim ticket / early-arrival request / duty manager / complimentary / room-ready time / review

01 **Ms Vega:** I asked to arrive at noon, and your email said it was noted. It is already twelve fifteen. I expected to go straight to my room.

02 **Arun:** I understand your [1] _____, and I am sorry the message was unclear. Let me check the room status and explain what we can arrange now.

03 **Ms Vega:** I have been traveling since early this morning. I would have planned differently if I had known I might be waiting.

04 **Arun:** Your [2] _____ is in the booking record. It asked for noon access, but that access was not confirmed. Standard check-in begins at three this afternoon.

05 **Ms Vega:** Is there no possibility of a room before three? Should I leave and return later?

06 **Arun:** I cannot rule out earlier availability, but I do not have a verified [3] _____. No room has been released yet, so I should not give you an estimate as a promise.

07 **Ms Vega:** Another hotel promised twenty minutes, and I waited nearly two hours. I would prefer an honest answer to another guess.

08 **Arun:** That is reasonable. I can offer [4] _____ luggage storage now, and you may use the lobby seating. I will also check directly with housekeeping rather than leave your request without a follow-up.

09 **Ms Vega:** Please store the bags. I still need to decide whether to get something to eat nearby. How will I know whether anything has changed?

10 **Arun:** I will give you a personal [5] _____ at one o'clock. That update will happen even if we are still waiting. One o'clock is not a confirmed time for entering the room.

Conversation continues on the next page.

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ms Vega:** All right. I will stay in the lobby until then. Please do not send me to several departments to ask the same question again.

12 **Arun:** You can come back to me at the [6] _____. I will coordinate the check with housekeeping and tell you the result, so you do not need to repeat the request elsewhere.

13 **Ms Vega:** Please also review that email. It sounded as though my early arrival had been approved.

14 **Arun:** I will pass that concern to the [7] _____. I can describe the wording you received and the expectation it created, without suggesting that you caused the misunderstanding.

15 **Ms Vega:** Would the manager be able to consider some compensation for the inconvenience? I understand that you may not be the person who can decide.

16 **Arun:** I can submit that for [8] _____, but I cannot promise the outcome. For now, the confirmed arrangements are luggage storage, lobby seating, and my update at one o'clock.

17 **Ms Vega:** That is clear. I will hand over the bags now, and I will look for you here at one. Please update me even without good news.

18 **Arun:** I will. Once the bags are stored, I will give you a [9] _____ for collecting them. Please keep it with you, and let me know if you need something from the luggage while you wait.

19 **Ms Vega:** Thank you. I will wait here until one, then decide about lunch. Please come and find me even if the room is still not ready.

20 **Arun:** I will take care of the [10] _____: check with housekeeping, pass on your concern, and find you here at one. I will distinguish an estimate from a confirmed release.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. frustration / **2.** early-arrival request / **3.** room-ready time / **4.** complimentary / **5.** status update / **6.** front desk / **7.** duty manager / **8.** review / **9.** claim ticket / **10.** follow-through

Why these answers fit, page 114

F Check accuracy and scope

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

Return to the case

Ms Vega arrives at 12:15. Her confirmation says that her early-arrival request has been noted, but she understood this as guaranteed access at noon. Standard check-in begins at 15:00. No room has yet been released, and the front desk has no verified room-ready time. Complimentary luggage storage and use of the lobby seating are available now. Front-desk agent Arun can check with housekeeping and give a personal update at 13:00 even if the status has not changed. He cannot guarantee an earlier room or authorize compensation on his own.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement accurately explains complimentary storage?

A. Your whole stay is now free.
B. You must accept storage instead of a room.
C. Storage guarantees immediate room access.
D. We can hold your luggage without an additional charge.

2. What should Arun do if compensation is requested?

A. Promise approval before checking.
B. Delete the booking to remove the dispute.
C. Say no manager can ever consider it.
D. Refer the request for the duty manager's review.

Answers and explanations, page 116

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 9-12 and 17-20; stress one as the update time, not the room-access time.

Service language can create a commitment

Noted, requested, and confirmed can sound interchangeable to a tired traveler. Explain their difference without treating the guest as foolish. A calm apology for unclear communication can sit beside an honest limit on what is currently available.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

An update is not a release time

At 11:30, no room is released. Free luggage storage is confirmed. The agent commits to an update at 12:00 but has no verified access time.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

luggage / room access / update / complimentary

01 **Guest:** Is noon a guaranteed time for [1] _____?

02 **Agent:** No; noon is the time for my [2] _____.

03 **Guest:** Can you hold my [3] _____ while I wait?

04 **Agent:** Yes, that service is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. room access / **2.** update / **3.** luggage / **4.** complimentary

Why these answers fit, page 116

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An early-arrival request sounded like a promise". Ms Vega: "Please also review that email. It sounded as though my early arrival had been approved." Arun: [missing response] Ms Vega: "Would the manager be able to consider some compensation for the inconvenience? I understand that you may not be the person who can decide." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I can submit that for review, but I cannot promise the outcome. For now, the confirmed arrangements are luggage storage, lobby seating, and my update at one o'clock.

B. I will take care of the follow-through: check with housekeeping, pass on your concern, and find you here at one. I will distinguish an estimate from a confirmed release.

C. Your early-arrival request is in the booking record. It asked for noon access, but that access was not confirmed. Standard check-in begins at three this afternoon.

D. I will pass that concern to the duty manager. I can describe the wording you received and the expectation it created, without suggesting that you caused the misunderstanding.

Answers and explanations, page 117

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / COMPLAINT HANDLING AND ONLINE REVIEWS

Acknowledge a complaint, protect booking details, and move investigation to the appropriate private channel.

A public reply should not become a public argument

Guest-relations agent Elise reviews a draft reply to a public complaint about late-night noise. The draft accuses the guest of exaggerating and includes the room number, stay dates, and booking reference. The complaint has not yet been checked against the property records. Manager Mateo requires a brief, courteous public acknowledgement and an invitation to contact the property through its published guest-relations channel. The private review will verify relevant records before any remedy is decided. Any approved remedy must be independent of whether the guest edits or removes the review.

People: Elise, Guest-relations agent; Mateo, Guest-services manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is established about the noise complaint?

A. Every detail has been verified.
B. A refund has already been approved.
C. It has been reported but not yet checked.
D. It has been disproved.

2. Which information should be removed from the public draft?

A. A courteous acknowledgement
B. The published guest-relations channel
C. A brief invitation to contact the property
D. Room number, stay dates, and booking reference

3. What may an approved remedy depend on here?

A. Removal of the review
B. A five-star replacement review
C. Public praise for the manager
D. The outcome of the service review and applicable policy

Answers and explanations, page 118

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

public reply
A response visible to other readers of a review.
publish a public reply

guest feedback
Information guests provide about their experience.
respond to guest feedback

service lapse
A failure to provide an expected service standard.
verify a service lapse

defensive tone
Language focused on protecting oneself from criticism.
remove a defensive tone

booking reference
An identifier for a particular reservation.
protect the booking reference

private channel
A communication route not open to public readers.
use the approved private channel

reviewer
A person who posts an account or evaluation.
acknowledge the reviewer

noise complaint
A report of unwanted or disruptive sound.
investigate a noise complaint

acknowledgement
Recognition that a concern has been received.
give a courteous acknowledgement

personal attack
Criticism directed at the person rather than the issue.
avoid personal attacks

stay dates
The dates covered by a guest's visit.
verify stay dates privately

published contact details
Official contact information available to customers.
use published contact details

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

public reply PUBLIC REPLY

publish a public reply

Keep the meaning precise: A response visible to other readers of a review.

acknowledgement ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

give a courteous acknowledgement

Keep the meaning precise: Recognition that a concern has been received.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

case record
The controlled account of a complaint and its handling.
update the case record

complaint handler
The person responsible for progressing a concern.
assign a complaint handler

factual check
Verification of a claim against relevant information.
complete a factual check

incident log
A record of reported events and actions.
consult the incident log

service remedy
An action offered to address a service problem.
authorize a service remedy

goodwill gesture
A discretionary offer intended to repair a relationship.
consider a goodwill gesture

conditional offer
An offer dependent on a stated condition.
reject an improper conditional offer

review incentive
A benefit offered to influence a review.
avoid a review incentive

reputational risk
The possibility of damage to public trust.
reduce reputational risk

response template
A reusable structure for a written reply.
adapt a response template

unverified allegation
A claim not yet established through checking.
distinguish an unverified allegation

resolution status
The current position of a complaint outcome.
report the resolution status

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

published contact details PUBLISHED CONTACT DETAILS

use published contact details

Keep the meaning precise: Official contact information available to customers.

service remedy SERVICE REMEDY

authorize a service remedy

Keep the meaning precise: An action offered to address a service problem.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Recognize the concern

Thank you for raising your concern about the noise.

Avoid a premature finding

We would like to review the details with you.

Offer a private route

Please contact our published guest-relations channel.

Describe the current status

The complaint has not yet been checked.

Name responsibility

I will be the contact for the private review.

Avoid a premature remedy

No compensation decision has been made.

Reject a condition

We cannot offer a benefit in exchange for removing it.

Record the outcome

Update the case record after the review is complete.

Acknowledge disappointment

I am sorry to hear that your stay was disappointing.

Protect the booking

Please do not post your booking information publicly.

Remove the attack

That sentence challenges the guest's character, not the facts.

Request relevant evidence

Let us review the incident log and relevant records.

Keep the reply concise

The public response needs acknowledgement and a next step.

Keep the remedy separate

Any remedy will not depend on changing the review.

Use neutral wording

The guest reports late-night noise.

Close professionally

We welcome the opportunity to follow up directly.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Protect the booking
Useful wording: Please do not post your booking information publicly.

Purpose: Offer a private route
Useful wording: Please contact our published guest-relations channel.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which public reply is most appropriate?

A. Our investigation proves you are wrong, although we have not checked.

B. We are sorry to hear about the noise concern; please contact our published guest-relations channel so we can review it.

C. Your room number proves that you are exaggerating.

D. Delete the review and we will consider helping.

2. Which internal note is suitably neutral?

A. The guest is dishonest.

B. The noise definitely never happened.

C. The complaint is resolved because we replied.

D. The guest reports late-night noise; verification is pending.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A report of unwanted or disruptive sound. Which term fits?

A. factual check

B. booking reference

C. reputational risk

D. noise complaint

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "No, not yet. I used the original complaint and my colleague's impression of the conversation. That is not enough to establish whether the reported noise occurred." Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "Could the reply say that we are sorry to hear the stay was disappointing, then invite the guest to contact our published guest-relations channel?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Remove the booking reference and the other private details. Knowing the reservation does not justify publishing it. Have we actually checked the complaint against the relevant property records yet?

B. Then describe it as guest feedback awaiting review. Do not call the account false, and do not claim that we have already proved a service failure. Neither conclusion is established.

C. Consult the incident log as part of that work. Record what it supports and what remains uncertain. An absent entry alone should not become a sweeping claim that nothing happened.

D. Let us start with the public reply. It will be read by future guests as well. We need a calm acknowledgement and a useful next step, not an argument.

Answers and explanations, page 118

> **One useful distinction**
>
> An acknowledgement is not a finding that every allegation is correct. Equally, missing verification is not proof that the guest is wrong. The public reply should not announce the result of a review that has not occurred.

E Conversation

A public reply should not become a public argument

A public reply should not become a public argument

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

conditional offer / public reply / guest feedback / incident log / defensive tone / acknowledgement / service remedy / case record / booking reference / resolution status

01 **Elise:** Could you check my response to the noise review before I publish it? I was frustrated by the guest's description.

02 **Mateo:** Let us start with the [1] _____. It will be read by future guests as well. We need a calm acknowledgement and a useful next step, not an argument.

03 **Elise:** I included the room number and stay dates to show that we know the booking. I also said the guest exaggerated what happened that night.

04 **Mateo:** Remove the [2] _____ and the other private details. Knowing the reservation does not justify publishing it. Have we actually checked the complaint against the relevant property records yet?

05 **Elise:** No, not yet. I used the original complaint and my colleague's impression of the conversation. That is not enough to establish whether the reported noise occurred.

06 **Mateo:** Then describe it as [3] _____ awaiting review. Do not call the account false, and do not claim that we have already proved a service failure. Neither conclusion is established.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Elise:** Could the reply say that we are sorry to hear the stay was disappointing, then invite the guest to contact our published guest-relations channel?

08 **Mateo:** Yes. That provides an [4] _____ without announcing an investigation result. Keep it brief, and make the next step easy to find. We do not need to reconstruct the stay in public.

09 **Elise:** I will take that sentence out. Could you check the new wording after I remove the booking details as well?

10 **Mateo:** Exactly. That [5] _____ makes a factual conversation harder. We can explain relevant verified information later, but first we need a proper review and a clear person responsible.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A public reply should not become a public argument

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Elise:** I can handle the follow-up. Once the guest contacts us privately, I will confirm the necessary booking information through our approved process and review the available records.

12 **Mateo:** Consult the [6] _____ as part of that work. Record what it supports and what remains uncertain. An absent entry alone should not become a sweeping claim that nothing happened.

13 **Elise:** The handover suggests a credit, but only after the review comes down. We cannot use that condition, can we?

14 **Mateo:** Do not make that [7] _____. Any approved remedy must stand independently of review removal or revision. Our task is to address the service concern, not purchase a different public account.

15 **Elise:** Understood. I will not promise compensation in the initial reply either. We still need to check the facts and determine what our policy permits.

16 **Mateo:** Correct. A [8] _____ has not been decided. Explain that clearly in the private conversation if asked, and avoid language that suggests approval is automatic or impossible.

17 **Elise:** The public version now thanks the guest for raising the noise concern, acknowledges the disappointing experience, and directs them to the published contact route for follow-up.

18 **Mateo:** That is suitable. After publishing, create the [9] _____ and identify yourself as the contact. Preserve the distinction between the public acknowledgement and the unfinished private investigation.

A public reply should not become a public argument / continued

19 **Elise:** I will check the records before reaching a conclusion, then communicate any authorized outcome directly. The guest will remain free to leave the review as it is.

20 **Mateo:** Good. Update the [10] _____ when the review progresses. For now, mark it as awaiting private follow-up, not resolved merely because we have answered online.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. public reply / **2.** booking reference / **3.** guest feedback / **4.** acknowledgement / **5.** defensive tone / **6.** incident log / **7.** conditional offer / **8.** service remedy / **9.** case record / **10.** resolution status

Why these answers fit, page 120

F Check accuracy and scope

A public reply should not become a public argument

Return to the case

Guest-relations agent Elise reviews a draft reply to a public complaint about late-night noise. The draft accuses the guest of exaggerating and includes the room number, stay dates, and booking reference. The complaint has not yet been checked against the property records. Manager Mateo requires a brief, courteous public acknowledgement and an invitation to contact the property through its published guest-relations channel. The private review will verify relevant records before any remedy is decided. Any approved remedy must be independent of whether the guest edits or removes the review.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which proposal should be rejected?

A. Check the incident log.

B. Remove booking details from the public response.

C. Assign a private follow-up contact.

D. Offer a credit only if the guest removes the review.

2. What does posting the public reply establish?

A. The investigation is complete.

B. A refund is approved.

C. The guest has accepted a settlement.

D. The concern has received an acknowledgement and a next step.

Answers and explanations, page 121

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 13-16; make the rejection of a review-removal condition explicit.

A reply has more than one reader

A public response speaks to the reviewer and to future guests. Firmly correcting a verified fact may sometimes be appropriate, but arguing about an unverified account or revealing private details damages trust. Keep investigation and personal booking discussion in the approved private channel.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Resolve the service issue, not the rating

A guest posts a complaint about a delayed airport pickup. No investigation is complete. The draft reply includes a reservation code and offers a voucher only for deleting the review.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

reservation code / factual check / deletion / acknowledgement

01 **Manager:** Remove the [1] _____ from the public response.

02 **Agent:** We can give a courteous [2] _____ now.

03 **Manager:** The complaint still needs a [3] _____.

04 **Agent:** Any approved voucher must be independent of review [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. reservation code / **2.** acknowledgement / **3.** factual check / **4.** deletion

Why these answers fit, page 121

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "The handover suggests a credit, but only after the review comes down. We cannot use that condition, can we?" Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "Understood. I will not promise compensation in the initial reply either. We still need to check the facts and determine what our policy permits." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then describe it as guest feedback awaiting review. Do not call the account false, and do not claim that we have already proved a service failure. Neither conclusion is established.

B. Do not make that conditional offer. Any approved remedy must stand independently of review removal or revision. Our task is to address the service concern, not purchase a different public account.

C. Yes. That provides an acknowledgement without announcing an investigation result. Keep it brief, and make the next step easy to find. We do not need to reconstruct the stay in public.

D. Consult the incident log as part of that work. Record what it supports and what remains uncertain. An absent entry alone should not become a sweeping claim that nothing happened.

Answers and explanations, page 122

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation" and "Complaint Handling and Online Reviews". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A message documenting a booking and its stated terms. Which term fits?

A. room release

B. guest relations

C. reservation confirmation

D. expectation gap

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Criticism directed at the person rather than the issue. Which term fits?

A. public reply

B. conditional offer

C. personal attack

D. case record

3. Rebuild the exchange from "An early-arrival request sounded like a promise". Ms Vega: "Please store the bags. I still need to decide whether to get something to eat nearby. How will I know whether anything has changed?" Arun: [missing response] Ms Vega: "All right. I will stay in the lobby until then. Please do not send me to several departments to ask the same question again." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. You can come back to me at the front desk. I will coordinate the check with housekeeping and tell you the result, so you do not need to repeat the request elsewhere.

B. I will give you a personal status update at one o'clock. That update will happen even if we are still waiting. One o'clock is not a confirmed time for entering the room.

C. That is reasonable. I can offer complimentary luggage storage now, and you may use the lobby seating. I will also check directly with housekeeping rather than leave your request without a follow-up.

D. I cannot rule out earlier availability, but I do not have a verified room-ready time. No room has been released yet, so I should not give you an estimate as a promise.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "The public version now thanks the guest for raising the noise concern, acknowledges the disappointing experience, and directs them to the published contact route for follow-up." Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "I will check the records before reaching a conclusion, then communicate any authorized outcome directly. The guest will remain free to leave the review as it is." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Let us start with the public reply. It will be read by future guests as well. We need a calm acknowledgement and a useful next step, not an argument.

B. Exactly. That defensive tone makes a factual conversation harder. We can explain relevant verified information later, but first we need a proper review and a clear person responsible.

C. That is suitable. After publishing, create the case record and identify yourself as the contact. Preserve the distinction between the public acknowledgement and the unfinished private investigation.

D. Correct. A service remedy has not been decided. Explain that clearly in the private conversation if asked, and avoid language that suggests approval is automatic or impossible.

Answers and explanations, page 153

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / RESERVATIONS, OVERBOOKING, AND WALKS

Present verified alternatives, explain differences honestly, and obtain a guest decision before changing the booking.

The booked room type is unavailable

Mr Chen booked one king-bed room for tonight. That room type is unavailable. Duty manager Sofia has two verified alternatives: an on-site twin room with two separate beds at no additional charge, or a king-bed room at the nearby Harbor Hotel. For the off-site option, this property has approved payment of the room-price difference and a transfer; other expenses are not approved. Harbor Hotel has confirmed availability for tonight. Mr Chen has not selected an option. Sofia must explain the bed arrangements and location, check his preference, and complete the chosen arrangement before calling it confirmed.

People: Sofia, Duty manager; Mr Chen, Guest with a king-room booking.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which alternative preserves the booked bed arrangement?

A. Neither option has a confirmed bed type.
B. The king room at Harbor Hotel
C. The on-site twin room
D. Either option has one king bed.

2. What costs are approved for the off-site option?

A. Every expense during the stay
B. A future holiday
C. Only an unconfirmed taxi estimate
D. The room-price difference and transfer

3. Has the guest accepted an alternative?

A. Yes; the manager chose silently.
B. No; both alternatives are unavailable.
C. No; his choice is still required.
D. Yes; availability means acceptance.

Answers and explanations, page 123

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

room type
A category of accommodation with specified features.
verify the room type

king room
A room containing a king-size bed.
confirm a king room

twin room
A room with two separate beds.
offer a twin room

bed configuration
The number and arrangement of beds.
explain the bed configuration

overbooking
Accepting more bookings than the available capacity can accommodate.
manage an overbooking

room-type mismatch
A difference between booked and offered accommodation categories.
resolve a room-type mismatch

walk
Industry shorthand for relocating a guest to another property.
arrange a guest walk

relocation
Moving a booking or guest to another property.
explain the relocation

alternative accommodation
A substitute place to stay.
verify alternative accommodation

receiving property
The property accepting a relocated guest.
contact the receiving property

on-site
Located at the same property.
offer an on-site alternative

off-site
Located away from the original property.
arrange an off-site room

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

room type ROOM TYPE
verify the room type
Keep the meaning precise: A category of accommodation with specified features.

room-type mismatch ROOM-TYPE MISMATCH
resolve a room-type mismatch
Keep the meaning precise: A difference between booked and offered accommodation categories.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

availability check
Verification that a room or service can be supplied.

complete an availability check

transfer
Transport between locations.

arrange the approved transfer

approved allowance
A specifically authorized amount or type of support.

state the approved allowance

booking amendment
A documented change to an existing reservation.

confirm a booking amendment

arrival instructions
Directions for reaching or entering the receiving property.

provide arrival instructions

service commitment
A specific promise made about the service provided.

document the service commitment

rate difference
The difference between the two room prices.

cover the rate difference

incidental expense
An additional cost outside the basic room arrangement.

clarify incidental expenses

guest consent
The guest's agreement to the proposed arrangement.

obtain guest consent

confirmation number
An identifier for a confirmed booking.

verify the confirmation number

handover contact
The person coordinating the receiving end of an arrangement.

identify the handover contact

equivalent feature
A characteristic that genuinely matches the original requirement.

check equivalent features

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

off-site OFF-SITE

arrange an off-site room

Keep the meaning precise: Located away from the original property.

approved allowance APPROVED ALLOWANCE

state the approved allowance

Keep the meaning precise: A specifically authorized amount or type of support.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the problem directly

Your booked king-room type is unavailable tonight.

Introduce choices

I have two verified alternatives to explain.

Clarify the charge

There would be no additional room charge for that option.

Name the difference

That keeps the bed type but changes the location.

Bound the offer

Other expenses are not included in the approved arrangement.

Avoid assuming agreement

I have not changed your booking without your choice.

Complete the handover

I will confirm the booking and arrival details.

Use plain language

We can arrange accommodation at the nearby hotel.

Acknowledge responsibility

I am sorry we cannot provide the room type you reserved.

Describe the on-site option

We have a twin room here with two separate beds.

Describe the off-site option

Harbor Hotel has confirmed a king room for tonight.

Explain approved costs

We will cover the room-price difference and the transfer.

Ask what matters

Is the king bed or staying at this property more important?

Check the selection

Would you like me to arrange the Harbor Hotel option?

Keep timing accurate

I still need to confirm the transfer arrangements.

Close with a readback

Let me repeat the room, location, and costs we have agreed.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Describe the on-site option
Useful wording: We have a twin room here with two separate beds.

Purpose: Clarify the charge
Useful wording: There would be no additional room charge for that option.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which description is most accurate?

A. The twin room is identical to a king room.

B. The king room is on-site.

C. Both alternatives change only the price.

D. The twin room is on-site but has two separate beds.

2. Which statement overpromises?

A. I need your choice before completing the change.

B. We will pay every expense you incur.

C. The approved offer covers the price difference and transfer.

D. Harbor Hotel has a king room available tonight.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The number and arrangement of beds. Which term fits?

A. bed configuration

B. arrival instructions

C. alternative accommodation

D. transfer

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The booked room type is unavailable". Mr Chen: "That difference matters to us. What is the second option, and have you actually checked that the other hotel can provide the right room tonight?" Sofia: [missing response] Mr Chen: "Would I have to pay the difference? I do not want to arrive there and discover that this solution costs more than the booking I made." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will provide the arrival instructions once the booking is completed. They will identify the receiving contact and booking details, with the agreed room-price and transfer arrangements clearly recorded.

B. I will complete the booking amendment and coordinate with Harbor Hotel. I will check the room, arrival details, and payment arrangements so the receiving team has the same information.

C. The receiving property is Harbor Hotel nearby. They have confirmed that a king room is available tonight. That preserves the bed type, although it changes where you will stay.

D. The on-site option is a twin room with two separate beds, at no additional charge. It keeps you at this property, but it does not match your king-bed preference.

Answers and explanations, page 123

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A twin room does not preserve a king-bed configuration. A king room at another hotel preserves that feature but changes location. Neither alternative should be called identical to the original booking.

E Conversation

The booked room type is unavailable

The booked room type is unavailable

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

room type / booking amendment / readback / rate difference / twin room / arrival instructions / transfer / consent / relocation / receiving property

01 **Mr Chen:** I reserved a king room; two separate beds do not suit us. The receptionist mentioned a problem. What is available?

02 **Sofia:** I am sorry. Your booked [1] _____ is unavailable tonight. I have two verified alternatives, and I want to explain the differences before you choose either one.

03 **Mr Chen:** Please start with the option here. We would prefer not to move unless staying means losing the bed arrangement that we specifically booked.

04 **Sofia:** The on-site option is a [2] _____ with two separate beds, at no additional charge. It keeps you at this property, but it does not match your king-bed preference.

05 **Mr Chen:** That difference matters to us. What is the second option, and have you actually checked that the other hotel can provide the right room tonight?

06 **Sofia:** The [3] _____ is Harbor Hotel nearby. They have confirmed that a king room is available tonight. That preserves the bed type, although it changes where you will stay.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Mr Chen:** Would I have to pay the difference? I do not want to arrive there and discover that this solution costs more than the booking I made.

08 **Sofia:** Our approved arrangement covers the [4] _____ and the transfer to Harbor Hotel. Other expenses are not included. I will make that scope clear in the arrangements rather than leave you with an open-ended promise.

09 **Mr Chen:** The king room sounds better for us. Before you arrange it, please confirm we would not pay extra for the room or the transfer.

10 **Sofia:** Yes. I need your [5] _____ before completing the change. I have not treated the availability check as your acceptance or amended the booking without asking you.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The booked room type is unavailable

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mr Chen:** Then we choose the king room at Harbor Hotel for tonight. Please confirm the actual reservation before we leave with the luggage.

12 **Sofia:** I will complete the [6] _____ and coordinate with Harbor Hotel. I will check the room, arrival details, and payment arrangements so the receiving team has the same information.

13 **Mr Chen:** A member of staff used the word walk earlier. Does that mean we are expected to walk there with our bags? That would be difficult.

14 **Sofia:** No. That is internal shorthand for [7] _____. In your case, the approved offer includes transport. I should have explained the arrangement in ordinary language instead of leaving that term unclear.

15 **Mr Chen:** Do you have a transport departure time yet? Should we stay by reception or wait somewhere else?

16 **Sofia:** I still need to confirm the [8] _____ details. Please remain by reception while I coordinate them. I will not describe a departure time as confirmed until the transport arrangement is verified.

17 **Mr Chen:** That is fine. Before we leave, please give us the receiving contact and explain what we should show when we arrive at Harbor Hotel.

18 **Sofia:** I will provide the [9] _____ once the booking is completed. They will identify the receiving contact and booking details, with the agreed room-price and transfer arrangements clearly recorded.

19 **Mr Chen:** Could you put those details in writing? I do not want to explain the price and transport agreement again at Harbor Hotel.

20 **Sofia:** Certainly. First, a quick [10] _____: a king room at Harbor Hotel tonight, price difference and transfer covered, other expenses excluded. I will complete the arrangements and confirm them in writing before you leave.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. room type / **2.** twin room / **3.** receiving property / **4.** rate difference / **5.** consent / **6.** booking amendment / **7.** relocation / **8.** transfer / **9.** arrival instructions / **10.** readback

Why these answers fit, page 124

F Check accuracy and scope

The booked room type is unavailable

Return to the case

Mr Chen booked one king-bed room for tonight. That room type is unavailable. Duty manager Sofia has two verified alternatives: an on-site twin room with two separate beds at no additional charge, or a king-bed room at the nearby Harbor Hotel. For the off-site option, this property has approved payment of the room-price difference and a transfer; other expenses are not approved. Harbor Hotel has confirmed availability for tonight. Mr Chen has not selected an option. Sofia must explain the bed arrangements and location, check his preference, and complete the chosen arrangement before calling it confirmed.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should happen before changing the booking?

A. Explain the alternatives and obtain the guest's choice.
B. Select the cheaper alternative without asking.
C. Mark both hotels as occupied by the guest.
D. Announce that every detail is complete.

2. Which handover is complete in principle?

A. Promise unspecified costs later.
B. Verify the chosen booking, receiving contact, arrival details, and approved transfer.
C. Send the guest away with only a hotel name.
D. Treat room availability as a confirmed transfer.

Answers and explanations, page 126

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 13-20, explaining walk in ordinary language and reading back the included costs.

A substitute is not automatically equivalent

Two available rooms may differ in the feature that matters most to a guest. Describe beds, location, and approved costs plainly. Internal shorthand such as walk should not replace a respectful explanation of the actual accommodation arrangement.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A feature match still needs agreement

A guest booked a king bed. The local room has two singles. A nearby hotel has a verified king room; the approved offer covers its price difference and transport only.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

booking / transport / bed configuration / king bed

01 **Agent:** The local option has a different [1] _____.

02 **Guest:** The nearby option preserves the [2] _____.

03 **Agent:** Our offer includes the price difference and [3] _____.

04 **Guest:** Please confirm the details before changing my [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. bed configuration / **2.** king bed / **3.** transport / **4.** booking

Why these answers fit, page 126

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The booked room type is unavailable". Mr Chen: "A member of staff used the word walk earlier. Does that mean we are expected to walk there with our bags? That would be difficult." Sofia: [missing response] Mr Chen: "Do you have a transport departure time yet? Should we stay by reception or wait somewhere else?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The on-site option is a twin room with two separate beds, at no additional charge. It keeps you at this property, but it does not match your king-bed preference.

B. The receiving property is Harbor Hotel nearby. They have confirmed that a king room is available tonight. That preserves the bed type, although it changes where you will stay.

C. I will complete the booking amendment and coordinate with Harbor Hotel. I will check the room, arrival details, and payment arrangements so the receiving team has the same information.

D. No. That is internal shorthand for relocation. In your case, the approved offer includes transport. I should have explained the arrangement in ordinary language instead of leaving that term unclear.

Answers and explanations, page 127

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / REVENUE MANAGEMENT AND PRICING

Explain occupancy, average daily rate, and revenue per available room using the correct denominators.

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

Revenue analyst Mina reviews two single-night results with general manager Owen. Each night had 100 available rooms. On Night A, 80 rooms sold and room revenue was $8,000. On Night B, 60 rooms sold and room revenue was $7,200. These figures exclude non-room revenue; no cost figures are supplied. Owen calls the higher average daily rate a complete commercial improvement. Mina needs to distinguish the higher rate among sold rooms from the lower occupancy and lower revenue per available room. The two observations alone do not establish why demand changed.

People: Mina, Revenue analyst; Owen, General manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is Night B's average daily rate?

A. $120
B. $72
C. $60
D. $100

2. What is Night B's revenue per available room?

A. $7,200
B. $72
C. $120
D. $80

3. What cannot be calculated from the supplied figures?

A. Profit
B. Occupancy
C. Average daily rate
D. Room revenue per available room

Answers and explanations, page 128

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

average daily rate (ADR)
Room revenue divided by rooms sold for the period.

calculate average daily rate

occupancy rate
Rooms sold as a percentage of rooms available.

report the occupancy rate

revenue per available room (RevPAR)
Room revenue divided by available room supply.

compare revenue per available room

room revenue
Revenue from selling guest rooms.

distinguish room revenue

rooms sold
The count of paid room units sold in the stated period.

verify rooms sold

rooms available
Room supply available for the stated reporting period.

state rooms available

room night
One room for one night.

measure demand in room nights

non-room revenue
Revenue from services other than room sales.

separate non-room revenue

revenue management
Coordinating price and availability to manage revenue.

review revenue management

rate strategy
The approach used to set and vary selling prices.

evaluate the rate strategy

demand
Customer willingness and ability to purchase accommodation.

assess room demand

booking pace
The speed at which reservations accumulate for a date.

track booking pace

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

average daily rate (ADR) AVERAGE DAILY RATE (ADR)

calculate average daily rate

Keep the meaning precise: Room revenue divided by rooms sold for the period.

rooms available ROOMS AVAILABLE

state rooms available

Keep the meaning precise: Room supply available for the stated reporting period.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

pickup

The change in booked business between reporting points.

report booking pickup

on-the-books

Reservations already recorded for a future period.

review on-the-books revenue

forecast occupancy

The estimated share of rooms expected to sell.

revise forecast occupancy

market segment

A defined customer or business category.

compare market segments

channel mix

The proportions sold through different booking routes.

examine the channel mix

distribution cost

The expense associated with selling through a channel.

include distribution costs

net room revenue

Room revenue after the specified deductions.

define net room revenue

gross operating profit

Operating revenue less the relevant operating expenses.

distinguish gross operating profit

competitive set

A selected group of properties used for comparison.

review the competitive set

rate premium

A price above a stated comparison rate.

explain the rate premium

price elasticity

The responsiveness of demand to price changes.

assess price elasticity

revenue trade-off

A gain in one revenue driver offset by another change.

explain a revenue trade-off

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

booking pace BOOKING PACE

track booking pace

Keep the meaning precise: The speed at which reservations accumulate for a date.

channel mix CHANNEL MIX

examine the channel mix

Keep the meaning precise: The proportions sold through different booking routes.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the headline
Which measure do we mean by improved?

Give the first result
Night A sold 80 rooms for $8,000.

Explain ADR
Divide room revenue by rooms sold.

Explain occupancy
Sixty of one hundred rooms sold, or 60%.

Explain RevPAR
Divide room revenue by rooms available.

State the revenue change
Room revenue decreased by $800, or 10%.

Keep the scope clear
These figures concern rooms, not all hotel revenue.

Request useful context
Let us examine demand, segments, and channel mix.

State the common base
Both nights had 100 available rooms.

Give the second result
Night B sold 60 rooms for $7,200.

Report the rate change
ADR rose from $100 to $120.

Use points correctly
Occupancy fell by 20 percentage points.

Report the capacity yield
RevPAR fell from $80 to $72.

Avoid a profit claim
We do not have the costs needed to calculate profit.

Avoid causal overreach
This comparison does not isolate the effect of pricing.

Summarize the trade-off
A higher sold-room rate coincided with fewer rooms sold.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Give the second result
Useful wording: Night B sold 60 rooms for $7,200.

Purpose: Explain ADR
Useful wording: Divide room revenue by rooms sold.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which summary is accurate?

A. RevPAR excludes unsold available rooms.

B. ADR rose while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue fell.

C. Every room measure improved.

D. Higher ADR proves higher profit.

2. Which calculation gives Night A's RevPAR?

A. $8,000 divided by 100

B. $8,000 divided by 80

C. 80 divided by 100

D. 100 divided by 80

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Revenue from selling guest rooms. Which term fits?

A. forecast occupancy

B. room revenue

C. competitive set

D. revenue management

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "So the first average is one hundred dollars per sold room, and the second is one hundred and twenty. That is a twenty-percent increase." Mina: [missing response] Owen: "I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The higher ADR is real, but it is only one measure. We should look at how many rooms sold and what the available room supply earned as well.

B. Yes. Total room revenue also fell ten percent, from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred. The unchanged supply means those two percentage changes align in this comparison.

C. Correct. Meanwhile, occupancy moved from eighty percent to sixty percent. That is a fall of twenty percentage points, or twenty-five percent relative to the original eighty-percent level.

D. Use RevPAR. Eight thousand divided by one hundred is eighty dollars. Seven thousand two hundred divided by one hundred is seventy-two dollars. The capacity-based room revenue measure fell.

Answers and explanations, page 128

One useful distinction

Night A: occupancy 80%, ADR $100, RevPAR $80. Night B: occupancy 60%, ADR $120, RevPAR $72. ADR increased 20%, but RevPAR and total room revenue each decreased 10%. Occupancy fell 20 percentage points.

E Conversation

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

RevPAR / price elasticity / non-room revenue / occupancy / trade-off / cost figures / rooms available / channel mix / room revenue / ADR

01 **Owen:** Our average rate went up on the second night, so I have called it a complete commercial improvement. Is there anything missing from that summary?

02 **Mina:** The higher [1] _____ is real, but it is only one measure. We should look at how many rooms sold and what the available room supply earned as well.

03 **Owen:** Start with the room supply. I do not want to mistake a capacity change for performance.

04 **Mina:** Both nights had one hundred [2] _____. Night A sold eighty rooms for eight thousand dollars. Night B sold sixty rooms for seven thousand two hundred dollars. These are room-only revenue figures.

05 **Owen:** So the first average is one hundred dollars per sold room, and the second is one hundred and twenty. That is a twenty-percent increase.

06 **Mina:** Correct. Meanwhile, [3] _____ moved from eighty percent to sixty percent. That is a fall of twenty percentage points, or twenty-five percent relative to the original eighty-percent level.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Owen:** I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?

08 **Mina:** Use [4] _____. Eight thousand divided by one hundred is eighty dollars. Seven thousand two hundred divided by one hundred is seventy-two dollars. The capacity-based room revenue measure fell.

09 **Owen:** That means an eight-dollar reduction per available room. Relative to eighty dollars, it is ten percent lower, despite the higher average selling rate.

10 **Mina:** Yes. Total [5] _____ also fell ten percent, from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred. The unchanged supply means those two percentage changes align in this comparison.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Owen:** Could we still say that profit improved because we had fewer rooms to service? Fewer occupied rooms might mean some costs were lower.

12 **Mina:** That is possible, but we have no [6] _____ here. We cannot calculate profit or assume how expenses changed. A possible cost effect should remain a question, not become a reported financial result.

13 **Owen:** Fair point. What about restaurant and event spending? Those could change the property's total revenue even when the room figures move in the opposite direction.

14 **Mina:** They could, but [7] _____ is not included in this comparison. We should label the scope clearly instead of using the room result as a complete measure of hotel performance.

15 **Owen:** Can I say the price increase caused the occupancy fall, or do we need to look at the business mix first?

16 **Mina:** We need more evidence. We have not established [8] _____ or controlled other influences on demand. Let us compare the dates, segments, and booking patterns before attributing the whole decline to price.

17 **Owen:** Then the next discussion should look at context rather than force a cause into the headline. Which breakdown would make that review more useful?

18 **Mina:** Examine market segments and [9] _____, alongside demand and booking pace. Keep the same period and definitions, and include relevant costs before making a profitability claim.

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue / continued

19 **Owen:** I will revise the summary to say that ADR increased while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue declined. That is less sweeping and more informative.

20 **Mina:** Exactly. It describes the observed [10] _____ without treating one favorable metric as the whole result. We can then investigate why it happened and whether the strategy should change.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. ADR / **2.** rooms available / **3.** occupancy / **4.** RevPAR / **5.** room revenue / **6.** cost figures / **7.** non-room revenue / **8.** price elasticity / **9.** channel mix / **10.** trade-off

Why these answers fit, page 130

F Check accuracy and scope

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

Return to the case

Revenue analyst Mina reviews two single-night results with general manager Owen. Each night had 100 available rooms. On Night A, 80 rooms sold and room revenue was $8,000. On Night B, 60 rooms sold and room revenue was $7,200. These figures exclude non-room revenue; no cost figures are supplied. Owen calls the higher average daily rate a complete commercial improvement. Mina needs to distinguish the higher rate among sold rooms from the lower occupancy and lower revenue per available room. The two observations alone do not establish why demand changed.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which occupancy change is correctly stated?

A. A rise of 20 percentage points
B. No change because supply stayed constant
C. A fall of 20 percentage points
D. A fall of 20% relative

2. Which causal claim is justified by these two nights alone?

A. The lower occupancy proves the property was closed.
B. None; further evidence is needed to isolate a pricing effect.
C. The higher price caused every lost booking.
D. Demand changes never affect occupancy.

Answers and explanations, page 131

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 11-16, separating revenue, profit, and a causal claim about pricing.

Challenge the measure, not the person

A manager may use a familiar headline as shorthand for success. Name the calculation and its boundary before disagreeing with the conclusion. A precise comparison lets the team discuss pricing without turning a useful challenge into a contest over confidence.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Choose the right denominator

A hotel has 50 available rooms for one night. It sells 40 rooms and receives $6,000 in room revenue. No costs or non-room revenue are supplied.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

120 / 150 / profit / 80

01 **Analyst:** Occupancy is [1] _____ percent.

02 **Manager:** ADR is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Analyst:** RevPAR is [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Manager:** We cannot calculate [4] _____ from these figures alone.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 80 / **2.** 150 / **3.** 120 / **4.** profit

Why these answers fit, page 131

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "Fair point. What about restaurant and event spending? Those could change the property's total revenue even when the room figures move in the opposite direction." Mina: [missing response] Owen: "Can I say the price increase caused the occupancy fall, or do we need to look at the business mix first?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Both nights had one hundred rooms available. Night A sold eighty rooms for eight thousand dollars. Night B sold sixty rooms for seven thousand two hundred dollars. These are room-only revenue figures.

B. Use RevPAR. Eight thousand divided by one hundred is eighty dollars. Seven thousand two hundred divided by one hundred is seventy-two dollars. The capacity-based room revenue measure fell.

C. The higher ADR is real, but it is only one measure. We should look at how many rooms sold and what the available room supply earned as well.

D. They could, but non-room revenue is not included in this comparison. We should label the scope clearly instead of using the room result as a complete measure of hotel performance.

Answers and explanations, page 132

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks" and "Revenue Management and Pricing". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A room with two separate beds. Which term fits?

A. relocation
B. rate difference
C. confirmation number
D. twin room

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Revenue from services other than room sales. Which term fits?

A. net room revenue
B. non-room revenue
C. pickup
D. average daily rate (ADR)

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "I will take that sentence out. Could you check the new wording after I remove the booking details as well?" Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "I can handle the follow-up. Once the guest contacts us privately, I will confirm the necessary booking information through our approved process and review the available records." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. A service remedy has not been decided. Explain that clearly in the private conversation if asked, and avoid language that suggests approval is automatic or impossible.
B. Let us start with the public reply. It will be read by future guests as well. We need a calm acknowledgement and a useful next step, not an argument.
C. Exactly. That defensive tone makes a factual conversation harder. We can explain relevant verified information later, but first we need a proper review and a clear person responsible.
D. Remove the booking reference and the other private details. Knowing the reservation does not justify publishing it. Have we actually checked the complaint against the relevant property records yet?

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "Then the next discussion should look at context rather than force a cause into the headline. Which breakdown would make that review more useful?" Mina: [missing response] Owen: "I will revise the summary to say that ADR increased while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue declined. That is less sweeping and more informative." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Examine market segments and channel mix, alongside demand and booking pace. Keep the same period and definitions, and include relevant costs before making a profitability claim.

B. The higher ADR is real, but it is only one measure. We should look at how many rooms sold and what the available room supply earned as well.

C. Correct. Meanwhile, occupancy moved from eighty percent to sixty percent. That is a fall of twenty percentage points, or twenty-five percent relative to the original eighty-percent level.

D. Use RevPAR. Eight thousand divided by one hundred is eighty dollars. Seven thousand two hundred divided by one hundred is seventy-two dollars. The capacity-based room revenue measure fell.

Answers and explanations, page 156

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / HOUSEKEEPING, MAINTENANCE, AND TURNOVER

Read back separate department statuses and keep a room unavailable until the required release is recorded.

Clean does not yet mean released

Room 417 is cleaned and inspected by housekeeping, but its door-lock repair is still open in the maintenance record. The fictional property requires both housekeeping clearance and maintenance clearance before the duty manager releases a room to reception. Neither maintenance clearance nor the final release is recorded for 417. Reception wants to assign it to an arriving guest. Room 419 has both clearances and a recorded release; its room type and the guest-required features have been checked and match. Reception can assign 419 without changing 417 to available or promising when its repair will finish.

People: Leah, Reception supervisor; Marco, Rooms-division coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is missing for Room 417?

A. Maintenance clearance and final release
B. Housekeeping inspection
C. A room number
D. Evidence that the guest arrived

2. Which room can reception assign on the supplied facts?

A. Room 419
B. Room 417
C. Either room because both are clean
D. Neither room because no room type was checked

3. Who performs the final release in this fictional process?

A. Whoever sees a clean bed first
B. The duty manager
C. Any guest
D. The reservation website

Answers and explanations, page 133

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

room turnover
Preparing a room between guest stays.

coordinate room turnover

housekeeping clearance
Confirmation that the required housekeeping checks are complete.

record housekeeping clearance

maintenance clearance
Confirmation that the required maintenance conditions are satisfied.

obtain maintenance clearance

work order
A recorded request or instruction for maintenance work.

update a work order

open repair
A repair not yet recorded as completed and cleared.

track an open repair

door-lock fault
A reported problem with a door's locking system.

report a door-lock fault

inspection record
Documentation of a completed check and its result.

verify the inspection record

release authorization
Permission to make the room available for assignment.

verify release authorization

room status
The recorded operational condition of a room.

reconcile room status

property management system (PMS)
Software managing room, reservation, and guest operations.

update the PMS

out of order
A property-defined status taking a room out of use.

confirm an out-of-order status

out of service
A property-defined temporary unavailability status.

check the out-of-service code

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

room turnover ROOM TURNOVER

coordinate room turnover

Keep the meaning precise: Preparing a room between guest stays.

door-lock fault DOOR-LOCK FAULT

report a door-lock fault

Keep the meaning precise: A reported problem with a door's locking system.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

vacant clean

A room-status label indicating an unoccupied, cleaned room.

distinguish vacant clean

vacant dirty

A room-status label indicating cleaning is still required.

report vacant dirty

occupied room

A room currently assigned for guest use.

identify an occupied room

room discrepancy

A conflict between room records or observations.

resolve a room discrepancy

engineering department

The hotel team responsible for technical maintenance.

contact the engineering department

defect report

A record describing a fault needing attention.

submit a defect report

readback

Repetition of details to check shared understanding.

request a status readback

handover log

A record used to transfer operational responsibility.

update the handover log

release hold

A restriction preventing a room from being assigned.

maintain the release hold

guest-required feature

A room characteristic needed for the particular booking.

verify guest-required features

return to service

Authorized restoration of availability after required checks.

confirm return to service

status reconciliation

Checking and resolving differences among recorded statuses.

complete status reconciliation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

out of service OUT OF SERVICE

check the out-of-service code

Keep the meaning precise: A property-defined temporary unavailability status.

engineering department ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT

contact the engineering department

Keep the meaning precise: The hotel team responsible for technical maintenance.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Name the exact room
I am checking the release status for Room 417.

Identify the open item
The door-lock repair remains open.

Keep the hold clear
Do not assign 417 yet.

Ask for evidence
Please check the clearance and release records.

Offer the ready alternative
Room 419 has both clearances and final release.

Read back the action
Assign 419 and keep 417 unavailable.

Use neutral language
The maintenance clearance is still pending.

Report the guest outcome
We can accommodate the guest in the released alternative.

Separate department checks
Housekeeping is cleared, but maintenance is not.

State the missing authority
The duty manager's final release is not recorded.

Avoid a shortcut
Vacant clean is not the same as released under this process.

Avoid an invented deadline
I do not have a confirmed repair completion time.

Confirm suitability
Its room type and required features match.

Keep records consistent
Update the handover log without changing the repair status.

Name the next owner
The duty manager can release it after the required clearances.

Close the handover
Please confirm that reception has the same room status.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the missing authority
Useful wording: The duty manager's final release is not recorded.

Purpose: Keep the hold clear
Useful wording: Do not assign 417 yet.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which handover is accurate?

A. Close the repair to make the system look consistent.

B. Promise 417 will be ready in ten minutes.

C. Assign 419; keep 417 on hold until its required clearances and release are recorded.

D. Assign 417 because the bed is clean.

2. What does the housekeeping inspection prove here?

A. The lock repair is finished.

B. The duty manager has released the room.

C. The repair will finish before arrival.

D. The housekeeping checks are complete.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A recorded request or instruction for maintenance work. Which term fits?

A. room status

B. occupied room

C. release hold

D. work order

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Clean does not yet mean released". Leah: "I see an open work order for the lock. Could it simply be an old entry that someone forgot to close after finishing the repair?" Marco: [missing response] Leah: "The guest is still at the desk. Is 419 released, and does it match the booking? I would rather offer a confirmed alternative now." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That calls for status reconciliation. The labels may describe different checks rather than contradictory facts. Confirm their definitions and ensure reception sees whether final release has actually occurred.

B. The duty manager records return to service after both clearances. That is the process in this property. A maintenance update alone does not remove the final authorization requirement.

C. Keep the release hold in place. Housekeeping has completed its inspection, but the door-lock repair remains open. We need the remaining clearance and the duty manager's release.

D. It could need checking, but the work order is still open. We cannot turn that possibility into a completed repair. Ask the responsible team for the recorded status.

Answers and explanations, page 133

One useful distinction

Housekeeping clearance confirms its own checks. It does not close a maintenance work order or supply the duty manager's release. For 417, keep all three statuses distinct rather than translating clean into available.

E Conversation

Clean does not yet mean released

Clean does not yet mean released

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

release hold / room assignment / return to service / work order / maintenance clearance / housekeeping clearance / release authorization / status reconciliation / readback / handover log

01 **Leah:** Housekeeping says Room 417 is clean. The guest is waiting, so can I assign it now? The desk needs a clear answer before issuing keys.

02 **Marco:** Keep the [1] _____ in place. Housekeeping has completed its inspection, but the door-lock repair remains open. We need the remaining clearance and the duty manager's release.

03 **Leah:** The room screen shows vacant clean. I assumed that meant it was available, since the cleaning team had already finished its part.

04 **Marco:** That label describes [2] _____ here, not every release condition. We must check the separate maintenance and authorization records rather than infer that all teams have completed their work.

05 **Leah:** I see an open work order for the lock. Could it simply be an old entry that someone forgot to close after finishing the repair?

06 **Marco:** It could need checking, but the [3] _____ is still open. We cannot turn that possibility into a completed repair. Ask the responsible team for the recorded status.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Leah:** The guest is still at the desk. Is 419 released, and does it match the booking? I would rather offer a confirmed alternative now.

08 **Marco:** Room 419 has [4] _____, housekeeping clearance, and final release. Its room type and the guest-required features have been checked and match. It is the confirmed alternative available now.

09 **Leah:** Good. I will assign 419. I will not change 417 to available simply because we have solved this guest's immediate accommodation problem.

10 **Marco:** Exactly. The [5] _____ and the unresolved repair are separate matters. The guest can be accommodated while 417 remains unavailable under the current release process.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Clean does not yet mean released

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Leah:** What should I say if the guest asks why the originally considered room is not ready? I do not want to share a speculative technical diagnosis.

12 **Marco:** Say that it is awaiting the required [6] _____. Then explain that we have a released room matching the booking. Do not invent a repair deadline or blame a department.

13 **Leah:** I will put both statuses in the handover. The next shift needs to see why 417 says clean on one screen but unavailable on the other.

14 **Marco:** That calls for [7] _____. The labels may describe different checks rather than contradictory facts. Confirm their definitions and ensure reception sees whether final release has actually occurred.

15 **Leah:** For the handover, I will record 419 as the assigned room and 417 as unavailable, with its lock work order still open pending verification.

16 **Marco:** Include that in the [8] _____, together with the contact responsible for checking the maintenance status. Avoid marking the repair complete merely to make two screens display the same word.

17 **Leah:** Once the repair is cleared, does reception release 417 directly, or does the duty manager still need to record the final decision?

18 **Marco:** The duty manager records [9] _____ after both clearances. That is the process in this property. A maintenance update alone does not remove the final authorization requirement.

19 **Leah:** Let me repeat the action: assign 419, keep 417 unavailable, check the maintenance record, and wait for the duty manager's release before assigning 417.

20 **Marco:** That [10] _____ is correct. Please confirm the same status with the next shift. We have a practical guest solution and a separate outstanding room issue.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. release hold / **2.** housekeeping clearance / **3.** work order / **4.** maintenance clearance / **5.** room assignment / **6.** release authorization / **7.** status reconciliation / **8.** handover log / **9.** return to service / **10.** readback

Why these answers fit, page 134

F Check accuracy and scope

Clean does not yet mean released

Return to the case

Room 417 is cleaned and inspected by housekeeping, but its door-lock repair is still open in the maintenance record. The fictional property requires both housekeeping clearance and maintenance clearance before the duty manager releases a room to reception. Neither maintenance clearance nor the final release is recorded for 417. Reception wants to assign it to an arriving guest. Room 419 has both clearances and a recorded release; its room type and the guest-required features have been checked and match. Reception can assign 419 without changing 417 to available or promising when its repair will finish.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement about room-status codes is safest?

A. Every property uses identical definitions.
B. Any green screen label overrides an open repair.
C. Out of service always means cleaned and assignable.
D. Check the property's definitions and release rules.

2. Which response avoids blaming a team?

A. Housekeeping caused all delays.
B. Reception should ignore everyone else.
C. Maintenance clearance is pending; I will check the responsible contact.
D. Engineering never finishes anything.

Answers and explanations, page 136

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 15-20, distinguishing maintenance clearance from the final release.

Department labels answer different questions

Clean, repaired, inspected, and available may belong to separate checks. A colleague who insists on reading each status is protecting the handover, not criticizing another team. State the missing authorization and the ready alternative without blaming an entire department.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A completed task is not a complete release

Room 208 has housekeeping clearance but no maintenance clearance or manager release. Room 210 is fully released and matches the booking. The local process requires both clearances and manager release.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

210 / release / maintenance / unavailable

01 **Reception:** The released alternative is Room [1] _____.

02 **Coordinator:** Room 208 still lacks [2] _____ clearance.

03 **Reception:** It also needs the manager's final [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** Keep 208 [4] _____ until those requirements are met.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 210 / **2.** maintenance / **3.** release / **4.** unavailable

Why these answers fit, page 136

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Clean does not yet mean released". Leah: "I will put both statuses in the handover. The next shift needs to see why 417 says clean on one screen but unavailable on the other." Marco: [missing response] Leah: "For the handover, I will record 419 as the assigned room and 417 as unavailable, with its lock work order still open pending verification." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep the release hold in place. Housekeeping has completed its inspection, but the door-lock repair remains open. We need the remaining clearance and the duty manager's release.

B. The duty manager records return to service after both clearances. That is the process in this property. A maintenance update alone does not remove the final authorization requirement.

C. It could need checking, but the work order is still open. We cannot turn that possibility into a completed repair. Ask the responsible team for the recorded status.

D. That calls for status reconciliation. The labels may describe different checks rather than contradictory facts. Confirm their definitions and ensure reception sees whether final release has actually occurred.

Answers and explanations, page 137

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / EVENTS, BANQUETS, AND RUN OF SHOW

Turn an assumed event arrangement into a timed, owned, and acknowledged schedule entry.

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

Venue coordinator Ren and event planner Asha compare their schedules. The soundcheck has no confirmed time, room, or owner; each team assumed the other arranged it. They now have a verified slot in Room A from 10:30 to 11:00. Audio lead Vera has accepted responsibility, the required equipment is available, and audience doors open at 11:15. Vera will check the event microphone and playback feed during the slot. Ren will update the controlled run of show and send it to the affected teams; Asha will confirm their acknowledgement. Later changes require coordinated review rather than a silent edit.

People: Ren, Venue coordinator; Asha, Event planner.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What was missing from the earlier soundcheck arrangement?

A. The event's entire audience
B. Every piece of equipment in the building
C. Proof that the event had ended
D. Confirmed time, room, and owner

2. How long is the confirmed soundcheck slot?

A. Fifteen minutes
B. Forty-five minutes
C. One hour
D. Thirty minutes

3. What buffer remains before doors open?

A. Thirty minutes
B. No time
C. Forty-five minutes
D. Fifteen minutes

Answers and explanations, page 138

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

run of show
The timed sequence of event activities and responsibilities.

update the run of show

soundcheck
A scheduled test of the event's audio setup.

coordinate the soundcheck

audio lead
The person responsible for the audio work.

confirm the audio lead

playback feed
The audio signal from recorded material into the system.

test the playback feed

microphone check
Verification of the required microphone's operation.

complete a microphone check

doors open
The time attendees may enter the event space.

confirm doors-open time

cue
A signal to begin a particular event action.

call the cue

cue sheet
A list of event signals and related actions.

verify the cue sheet

stage manager
The person coordinating actions around the stage.

brief the stage manager

technical rehearsal
A practice session checking technical event elements.

schedule a technical rehearsal

room booking
A confirmed allocation of a space for a time.

verify the room booking

setup window
Time allocated to preparing the event space.

protect the setup window

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

run of show RUN OF SHOW

update the run of show

Keep the meaning precise: The timed sequence of event activities and responsibilities.

doors open DOORS OPEN

confirm doors-open time

Keep the meaning precise: The time attendees may enter the event space.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

strike
Removal of event equipment after use.
schedule the strike

load-in
Bringing equipment into the event location.
coordinate the load-in

load-out
Taking equipment out after the event.
confirm the load-out

banquet event order (BEO)
A detailed document specifying an event's service requirements.
reconcile the banquet event order

function sheet
A property document listing an event's operational requirements.
check the function sheet

headcount
The number of people expected or present.
confirm the headcount

room layout
The arrangement of seating, tables, and equipment.
approve the room layout

buffer time
Time reserved between activities for transition or delay.
preserve buffer time

task owner
The person accountable for completing a specified activity.
name the task owner

schedule version
An identified edition of the event timetable.
circulate the schedule version

acknowledgement
Confirmation that a message or instruction has been received.
obtain team acknowledgement

change control
The process for reviewing and communicating alterations.
follow event change control

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

setup window SETUP WINDOW

protect the setup window

Keep the meaning precise: Time allocated to preparing the event space.

function sheet FUNCTION SHEET

check the function sheet

Keep the meaning precise: A property document listing an event's operational requirements.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Expose the assumption
We both assumed the other team had arranged it.

Name the missing details
The schedule lacks a time, room, and owner.

Confirm the slot
Room A is available from 10:30 to 11:00.

Name the owner
Vera has accepted responsibility for the soundcheck.

Specify the scope
She will check the event microphone and playback feed.

Confirm readiness
The required equipment is available.

Protect the next event
Doors open at 11:15.

State the buffer
That leaves fifteen minutes between soundcheck and admission.

Update the shared record
I will revise the controlled run of show.

Identify the current version
Please use the updated schedule version.

Request acknowledgement
Confirm that the affected teams have received the change.

Avoid a silent edit
Any later change needs coordinated review.

Read back the details
Room A, 10:30 to 11:00, with Vera responsible.

Distinguish duration
The soundcheck lasts thirty minutes.

Clarify distribution
Ren will send the schedule; Asha will collect acknowledgements.

Close the gap
The task now has a confirmed time, place, and owner.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Name the owner
Useful wording: Vera has accepted responsibility for the soundcheck.

Purpose: Specify the scope
Useful wording: She will check the event microphone and playback feed.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which schedule entry is complete?

A. Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30-11:00, Vera, microphone and playback feed.

B. Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30-11:00, technical team, scope to follow.

C. Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30, Vera, microphone and playback; finish not listed.

D. Soundcheck: 10:30-11:00, Vera, microphone and playback; room awaiting confirmation.

2. What happens if soundcheck ends at 11:15 with doors unchanged?

A. The original schedule remains unaffected.

B. The fifteen-minute buffer disappears.

C. The buffer grows to thirty minutes.

D. Doors automatically move to noon.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The audio signal from recorded material into the system. Which term fits?

A. task owner

B. load-out

C. playback feed

D. stage manager

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "Please replace technical team with Vera on the schedule. I want the presenter to know exactly who is meeting them in Room A." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Vera will be listed as the task owner. I will also include Room A and both times. A start time alone would not show when the space must be ready for the next activity.

B. I will update the controlled run of show and send the identified version to the affected teams. The earlier notes should not remain competing sources for the soundcheck arrangement.

C. No. That assumption was shared without a named owner. We need to replace it with a definite entry, not ask both teams to keep expecting the other to act.

D. Follow change control. A later finish could affect the room handover and audience admission. We need coordinated review and a communicated update before treating a new time as agreed.

Answers and explanations, page 138

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The soundcheck is 10:30-11:00 in Room A, owned by Vera. Doors open at 11:15, leaving a 15-minute buffer. Moving the soundcheck finish to 11:15 would consume that buffer even if the start remained unchanged.

E Conversation

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

task owner / readback / buffer time / acknowledgement / Doors open / change control / playback feed / soundcheck / run of show / assumption

01 **Asha:** My team expected the venue to arrange the soundcheck. Your schedule just says audio before doors. Do we have a confirmed room and time anywhere?

02 **Ren:** No. That [1] _____ was shared without a named owner. We need to replace it with a definite entry, not ask both teams to keep expecting the other to act.

03 **Asha:** Agreed. I have checked Room A, and the available slot is ten thirty until eleven. Does that fit the equipment and audio lead?

04 **Ren:** Yes. Vera has accepted the [2] _____ responsibility, and the equipment is available. She will test the event microphone and playback feed during that slot.

05 **Asha:** Please replace technical team with Vera on the schedule. I want the presenter to know exactly who is meeting them in Room A.

06 **Ren:** Vera will be listed as the [3] _____. I will also include Room A and both times. A start time alone would not show when the space must be ready for the next activity.

07 **Asha:** The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test.

08 **Ren:** Correct. That is our [4] _____. It is not an unallocated extra rehearsal slot. Any change that consumes it needs a review of the handover before doors open.

09 **Asha:** A presenter asked whether playback was included. They were worried that the microphone might be checked while the recorded material was left until the session itself.

10 **Ren:** The [5] _____ is part of Vera's confirmed scope. I will put both items in the entry so the presenter and audio team can see the same expectation.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Asha:** Which document should people use? There is an old planning email, my event schedule, and a venue copy with the vague audio note.

12 **Ren:** I will update the controlled [6] _____ and send the identified version to the affected teams. The earlier notes should not remain competing sources for the soundcheck arrangement.

13 **Asha:** I will ask the affected teams to confirm receipt. Sending the revised version is necessary, but we need to know they have actually seen the change.

14 **Ren:** Thank you. Their [7] _____ closes the communication step. If someone raises a conflict, we should resolve it explicitly rather than interpret silence as acceptance of every detail.

15 **Asha:** If Vera later needs more time, should she simply edit the finish in the shared document, or contact us before changing the schedule?

16 **Ren:** Follow [8] _____. A later finish could affect the room handover and audience admission. We need coordinated review and a communicated update before treating a new time as agreed.

17 **Asha:** I will flag eleven fifteen to the admission team. They have an older copy with eleven on it, so we need that copy replaced.

18 **Ren:** Exactly. [9] _____ remains eleven fifteen. Keep that separate from setup and testing times, even though all three activities occur in the same room sequence.

19 **Asha:** To confirm: Room A, ten thirty to eleven, Vera responsible, microphone and playback checked, then a fifteen-minute buffer before audience admission.

20 **Ren:** That [10] _____ captures it. I will send the revised run of show, and you will collect team acknowledgements. We now have an arrangement instead of a shared assumption.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. assumption / **2.** soundcheck / **3.** task owner / **4.** buffer time / **5.** playback feed / **6.** run of show / **7.** acknowledgement / **8.** change control / **9.** Doors open / **10.** readback

Why these answers fit, page 139

F Check accuracy and scope

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

Return to the case

Venue coordinator Ren and event planner Asha compare their schedules. The soundcheck has no confirmed time, room, or owner; each team assumed the other arranged it. They now have a verified slot in Room A from 10:30 to 11:00. Audio lead Vera has accepted responsibility, the required equipment is available, and audience doors open at 11:15. Vera will check the event microphone and playback feed during the slot. Ren will update the controlled run of show and send it to the affected teams; Asha will confirm their acknowledgement. Later changes require coordinated review rather than a silent edit.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement correctly separates responsibilities?

A. Nobody owns communication after the edit.
B. Asha silently edits Vera's task.
C. Vera alone must guess every team's needs.
D. Ren updates and sends; Asha confirms affected-team acknowledgement.

2. What is the best response to a later timing change?

A. Change one private copy only.
B. Assume the buffer will absorb any delay.
C. Treat an unread email as acceptance.
D. Review its effects with the relevant teams and issue an acknowledged update.

Answers and explanations, page 141

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 11-18, distinguishing the current schedule from superseded copies.

Shared awareness is not shared responsibility

An event team may all know that a soundcheck is needed while nobody has actually arranged it. Name the owner, location, start, finish, and affected handovers. Asking for a readback can be a practical coordination habit rather than a sign of distrust.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Protect the handover interval

An event test runs from 09:20 to 09:50 in Hall B. Audio lead Jo owns it. Doors open at 10:00. The coordinator must circulate the updated schedule and receive acknowledgement.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

30 / Jo / acknowledgement / 10

01 **Planner:** The test lasts [1] _____ minutes.

02 **Coordinator:** The buffer before doors is [2] _____ minutes.

03 **Planner:** The named task owner is [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** After circulation, collect team [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 30 / **2.** 10 / **3.** Jo / **4.** acknowledgement

Why these answers fit, page 141

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "I will ask the affected teams to confirm receipt. Sending the revised version is necessary, but we need to know they have actually seen the change." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "If Vera later needs more time, should she simply edit the finish in the shared document, or contact us before changing the schedule?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That readback captures it. I will send the revised run of show, and you will collect team acknowledgements. We now have an arrangement instead of a shared assumption.

B. The playback feed is part of Vera's confirmed scope. I will put both items in the entry so the presenter and audio team can see the same expectation.

C. Correct. That is our buffer time. It is not an unallocated extra rehearsal slot. Any change that consumes it needs a review of the handover before doors open.

D. Thank you. Their acknowledgement closes the communication step. If someone raises a conflict, we should resolve it explicitly rather than interpret silence as acceptance of every detail.

Answers and explanations, page 142

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover" and "Events, Banquets, and Run of Show". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Confirmation that the required maintenance conditions are satisfied. Which term fits?

A. vacant dirty

B. handover log

C. release authorization

D. maintenance clearance

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A list of event signals and related actions. Which term fits?

A. room layout

B. strike

C. cue sheet

D. run of show

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "That means an eight-dollar reduction per available room. Relative to eighty dollars, it is ten percent lower, despite the higher average selling rate." Mina: [missing response] Owen: "Could we still say that profit improved because we had fewer rooms to service? Fewer occupied rooms might mean some costs were lower." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The higher ADR is real, but it is only one measure. We should look at how many rooms sold and what the available room supply earned as well.

B. Use RevPAR. Eight thousand divided by one hundred is eighty dollars. Seven thousand two hundred divided by one hundred is seventy-two dollars. The capacity-based room revenue measure fell.

C. Exactly. It describes the observed trade-off without treating one favorable metric as the whole result. We can then investigate why it happened and whether the strategy should change.

D. Yes. Total room revenue also fell ten percent, from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred. The unchanged supply means those two percentage changes align in this comparison.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "I will flag eleven fifteen to the admission team. They have an older copy with eleven on it, so we need that copy replaced." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "To confirm: Room A, ten thirty to eleven, Vera responsible, microphone and playback checked, then a fifteen-minute buffer before audience admission." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Doors open remains eleven fifteen. Keep that separate from setup and testing times, even though all three activities occur in the same room sequence.

B. Correct. That is our buffer time. It is not an unallocated extra rehearsal slot. Any change that consumes it needs a review of the handover before doors open.

C. Thank you. Their acknowledgement closes the communication step. If someone raises a conflict, we should resolve it explicitly rather than interpret silence as acceptance of every detail.

D. Yes. Vera has accepted the soundcheck responsibility, and the equipment is available. She will test the event microphone and playback feed during that slot.

Answers and explanations, page 159

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / TOUR OPERATIONS AND TRAVELER SAFETY

Communicate an active tour hold, identify decision authority, and give an update without promising departure.

> **A weather update is not permission to depart**
>
> At 09:10, thunderstorms have triggered the tour operator's local departure hold for a coastal excursion. Guests are already inside the hotel's designated indoor waiting lounge, away from windows. Tour-desk agent Camila must keep the group there under the current plan; she cannot clear departure. The operator has not confirmed a route, restart, or cancellation. Operations lead Ben is responsible for the operational decision and will send a status update at 09:30. No refund or alternative excursion has been approved. Camila can promise to relay that update, including an unchanged hold, but cannot promise that the group will leave at 09:30.

People: Camila, Tour-desk agent; Mr Ellis, Excursion guest.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is the current operational status?

A. The tour has been canceled.
B. The coastal route has been cleared.
C. Departure is on hold under the operator's plan.
D. Departure is confirmed for 09:30.

2. What should the group do now in this case?

A. Treat clearer-looking sky as authorization.
B. Remain in the designated indoor lounge under the current plan.
C. Wait outside beside the coach.
D. Decide by a guest vote to depart.

3. Who makes the operational decision?

A. Any guest who has traveled before
B. Camila acting independently
C. The person posting the earliest online comment
D. Operations lead Ben

Answers and explanations, page 143

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

excursion
A planned short trip or organized visitor activity.

coordinate a coastal excursion

tour operator
The organization responsible for providing the tour.

contact the tour operator

departure hold
A temporary restriction preventing the tour from leaving.

maintain the departure hold

operational clearance
Authorized permission to proceed under the relevant process.

await operational clearance

operations lead
The person responsible for the operational decision.

consult the operations lead

weather advisory
Information warning of relevant weather conditions.

monitor weather advisories

thunderstorm
A storm involving thunder and lightning.

respond to a thunderstorm

lightning safety plan
A documented procedure for managing lightning-related activity risk.

follow the lightning safety plan

designated shelter
A specifically identified protective location in the local plan.

use the designated shelter

indoor waiting area
An internal location assigned for guests awaiting instructions.

identify the indoor waiting area

route assessment
A review of the conditions affecting a proposed route.

await the route assessment

itinerary
The planned sequence of trip activities and locations.

revise the itinerary

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

excursion EXCURSION

coordinate a coastal excursion

Keep the meaning precise: A planned short trip or organized visitor activity.

weather advisory WEATHER ADVISORY

monitor weather advisories

Keep the meaning precise: Information warning of relevant weather conditions.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

departure clearance

Approval for the group or vehicle to leave.

distinguish departure clearance

cancellation notice

A message confirming that a planned service will not operate.

issue a cancellation notice

rebooking

Moving a reservation to another service or time.

check rebooking options

passenger manifest

A controlled list of people on the tour or transport.

check the passenger manifest

meeting point

The specified place where a group is to assemble.

confirm the meeting point

all-clear

An authorized statement that a specified restriction can end.

avoid an assumed all-clear

restart decision

A determination that a suspended activity may resume.

communicate the restart decision

contingency arrangement

A prepared alternative if the original plan cannot proceed.

verify contingency arrangements

refund eligibility

Whether the applicable conditions permit money to be returned.

verify refund eligibility

group accountability

Knowing where the members of a group are.

maintain group accountability

communication chain

The route by which authorized information reaches others.

follow the communication chain

travel disruption

An interruption to planned transport or activities.

explain the travel disruption

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

itinerary ITINERARY

revise the itinerary

Keep the meaning precise: The planned sequence of trip activities and locations.

rebooking REBOOKING

check rebooking options

Keep the meaning precise: Moving a reservation to another service or time.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the hold first

Departure is currently on hold.

Name the responsible authority

Our operations lead is reviewing the conditions.

Give the communication time

The operator will send an update at 09:30.

Keep the instruction active

The hold remains in place until authorized instructions change.

Acknowledge the inconvenience

I understand this affects your plans for the day.

Keep cancellation distinct

Cancellation has not been confirmed.

Own the communication

I will relay the operator's update to the group.

Clarify a conditional option

Any alternative excursion would need confirmation.

Explain the present action

Please remain in the designated indoor lounge.

Avoid a route promise

No route has been confirmed.

Separate the meanings

That is an update time, not a departure time.

Reject an informal all-clear

I cannot clear departure based on how the sky looks.

Avoid guessing

I do not have a verified restart time.

Keep money decisions distinct

No refund decision has been approved yet.

Preserve an unchanged status

I will update you even if the hold remains.

Close with the current instruction

For now, please stay in this designated indoor area.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid a route promise
Useful wording: No route has been confirmed.

Purpose: Give the communication time
Useful wording: The operator will send an update at 09:30.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which announcement is accurate?

A. We will definitely depart at 09:30.

B. The weather looks better, so everyone should board now.

C. Every ticket has already been refunded.

D. Departure remains on hold; the next operator update is at 09:30.

2. What should Camila do if guests demand an immediate departure?

A. Repeat the active instruction and refer the decision through the operator's process.

B. Let a majority vote override the hold.

C. Invent clearance to reduce frustration.

D. Send the group outside while waiting for permission.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Authorized permission to proceed under the relevant process. Which term fits?

A. operational clearance

B. meeting point

C. designated shelter

D. cancellation notice

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A weather update is not permission to depart". Mr Ellis: "The sky looks brighter. Could the driver take us out now and avoid the worst part of the coast?" Camila: [missing response] Mr Ellis: "Has the operator canceled it, or are they still deciding? My family heard both versions in the lobby." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The route assessment has not produced a confirmed route for us. Cancellation is also unconfirmed. The current status is a hold, with the group remaining in the designated indoor area.

B. We need operational clearance, not a judgment based on a brighter patch of sky. Our operations lead, Ben, is responsible for the decision. I cannot clear departure myself.

C. No. The departure hold remains in place. Please stay in this designated indoor lounge, away from the windows, under the operator's current plan. Nine thirty is the next update.

D. I will. The communication chain is Ben to the desk and then to the group. I will make the current status and next instruction explicit when I relay the update.

Answers and explanations, page 143

> **One useful distinction**
>
> 09:30 is the operator's status-update time. It is not a confirmed departure, restart, route, or cancellation time. Camila relays the authorized status; she does not replace the operations lead's decision with her own forecast.

E Conversation

A weather update is not permission to depart

A weather update is not permission to depart

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

refund eligibility / rebooking / route assessment / status update / communication chain / operational clearance / all-clear / indoor waiting area / departure hold / travel disruption

01 **Mr Ellis:** Somebody mentioned nine thirty. Is that our new departure time? Should we get our bags ready outside?

02 **Camila:** No. The [1] _____ remains in place. Please stay in this designated indoor lounge, away from the windows, under the operator's current plan. Nine thirty is the next update.

03 **Mr Ellis:** Thank you for making that clear. I am worried about losing the whole day, especially because we booked another activity later this afternoon.

04 **Camila:** I understand the [2] _____. I will give you verified information as it arrives. At present, no route or restart time has been confirmed, so I cannot promise when the excursion will begin.

05 **Mr Ellis:** The sky looks brighter. Could the driver take us out now and avoid the worst part of the coast?

06 **Camila:** We need [3] _____, not a judgment based on a brighter patch of sky. Our operations lead, Ben, is responsible for the decision. I cannot clear departure myself.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Mr Ellis:** Has the operator canceled it, or are they still deciding? My family heard both versions in the lobby.

08 **Camila:** Correct. The [4] _____ has not produced a confirmed route for us. Cancellation is also unconfirmed. The current status is a hold, with the group remaining in the designated indoor area.

09 **Mr Ellis:** Will we hear from you at nine thirty even without a decision, or should we keep asking at the desk?

10 **Camila:** I will relay the [5] _____ to the group even if the hold is unchanged. You should not have to interpret silence or assume that no message means permission to leave.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A weather update is not permission to depart

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mr Ellis:** I appreciate that. Would a cancellation mean that we automatically receive our money back, or move to another excursion today?

12 **Camila:** I need to verify [6] _____ and any available alternatives before promising either outcome. No refund or replacement excursion has been approved. Those arrangements are separate from the immediate departure decision.

13 **Mr Ellis:** Please check with us before moving the booking. An afternoon replacement might clash with our other activity, even if it sounds similar.

14 **Camila:** Of course. Any [7] _____ would need a confirmed option and your agreement. I will explain the actual itinerary and relevant terms if an alternative becomes available, rather than treating it as already arranged.

15 **Mr Ellis:** Where should our group wait so that we do not miss the announcement?

16 **Camila:** Stay together in this [8] _____. If someone needs assistance, please tell the desk. We will use the operator's communication process and keep the current instruction clear until it changes.

17 **Mr Ellis:** I will tell the others that nine thirty means news, not departure. I will also explain that neither cancellation nor a refund has been decided.

18 **Camila:** That is accurate. There is no [9] _____ at present. I know waiting is inconvenient, but I should not soften that message into a suggestion that the group may choose to depart.

19 **Mr Ellis:** Understood. We will remain here and wait for the operator's message. Please include us even if the next announcement only says the hold continues.

20 **Camila:** I will. The [10] _____ is Ben to the desk and then to the group. I will make the current status and next instruction explicit when I relay the update.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. departure hold / **2.** travel disruption / **3.** operational clearance / **4.** route assessment / **5.** status update / **6.** refund eligibility / **7.** rebooking / **8.** indoor waiting area / **9.** all-clear / **10.** communication chain

Why these answers fit, page 144

F Check accuracy and scope

A weather update is not permission to depart

Return to the case

At 09:10, thunderstorms have triggered the tour operator's local departure hold for a coastal excursion. Guests are already inside the hotel's designated indoor waiting lounge, away from windows. Tour-desk agent Camila must keep the group there under the current plan; she cannot clear departure. The operator has not confirmed a route, restart, or cancellation. Operations lead Ben is responsible for the operational decision and will send a status update at 09:30. No refund or alternative excursion has been approved. Camila can promise to relay that update, including an unchanged hold, but cannot promise that the group will leave at 09:30.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement about cancellation is supported?

A. It has not been confirmed.
B. It is certain because a hold exists.
C. It is impossible because tickets were sold.
D. It was approved at 09:10.

2. Which financial statement fits the facts?

A. A status update automatically approves compensation.
B. Refund eligibility and any remedy still require confirmation.
C. Every guest is guaranteed an immediate refund.
D. No guest can ever receive a refund.

Answers and explanations, page 146

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 9-14, making update, departure, cancellation, and rebooking distinct.

Reassurance must not weaken the instruction

Guests under time pressure may hear an update time as a departure time. State the current hold first, identify the decision-maker, and repeat what guests should do now. A friendly tone should not turn an active safety instruction into an optional suggestion.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Do not turn a message time into a journey time

A local tour hold remains active. The group is in the designated indoor lounge. The operator promises an 11:00 update but has not cleared a route, departure, cancellation, or refund.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

hold / lounge / departure / update

01 **Guest:** Does eleven mean [1] _____?

02 **Agent:** No; eleven is the next [2] _____.

03 **Guest:** We should remain in the designated indoor [3] _____.

04 **Agent:** Correct; the operational [4] _____ remains active.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. departure / **2.** update / **3.** lounge / **4.** hold

Why these answers fit, page 146

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A weather update is not permission to depart". Mr Ellis: "Please check with us before moving the booking. An afternoon replacement might clash with our other activity, even if it sounds similar." Camila: [missing response] Mr Ellis: "Where should our group wait so that we do not miss the announcement?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Of course. Any rebooking would need a confirmed option and your agreement. I will explain the actual itinerary and relevant terms if an alternative becomes available, rather than treating it as already arranged.

B. Correct. The route assessment has not produced a confirmed route for us. Cancellation is also unconfirmed. The current status is a hold, with the group remaining in the designated indoor area.

C. I will relay the status update to the group even if the hold is unchanged. You should not have to interpret silence or assume that no message means permission to leave.

D. I understand the travel disruption. I will give you verified information as it arrives. At present, no route or restart time has been confirmed, so I cannot promise when the excursion will begin.

Answers and explanations, page 147

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / CULTURAL EXPECTATIONS AND SERVICE STYLE

Clarify an individual service preference, limit its scope, and distinguish a request from a confirmed arrangement.

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

Ms Rahman declines morning housekeeping on the first day of a three-night stay. A colleague assumes guests from her country never want housekeeping and proposes canceling routine service for the whole stay. Guest-relations agent Nico checks directly. Ms Rahman wants no routine room entry before 14:00 today and would like service after 14:00 if available. The afternoon team has not yet confirmed a slot. Her preference for later days has not been stated. Nico can record today's request and seek confirmation, but cannot promise the time or infer future preferences. Emergency access follows the property's separate rules.

People: Nico, Guest-relations agent; Ms Rahman, Staying guest.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What does Ms Rahman want before 14:00 today?

A. No routine room entry
B. No service for the entire stay
C. An immediate room inspection
D. Automatic cancellation of the booking

2. What is the status of afternoon service?

A. Guaranteed at 14:00
B. Completed
C. Refused for every day
D. Requested but not yet confirmed

3. What is known about later days?

A. The same time is guaranteed.
B. Nationality supplies the missing preference.
C. No preference has been stated.
D. Service is permanently declined.

Answers and explanations, page 148

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

service preference
An individual's stated choice about how service is provided.

clarify a service preference

do-not-disturb request
A request to avoid routine interruption.

record a do-not-disturb request

service window
A period during which a service may be provided.

confirm the service window

service frequency
How often a service is provided.

clarify service frequency

opt in
Choose to receive a specified optional service.

opt in to service

scope of request
The limits of what a person has asked for.

confirm the scope of request

routine room entry
Entry for ordinary scheduled room service tasks.

limit routine room entry

stayover service
Housekeeping provided while a guest continues a stay.

coordinate stayover service

afternoon slot
An available time allocation later in the day.

verify an afternoon slot

opt out
Choose not to receive a specified optional service.

opt out for today

preference note
A record of an explicitly stated service choice.

update the preference note

duration of stay
The total period of the guest's visit.

distinguish the duration of stay

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

service preference SERVICE PREFERENCE

clarify a service preference

Keep the meaning precise: An individual's stated choice about how service is provided.

afternoon slot AFTERNOON SLOT

verify an afternoon slot

Keep the meaning precise: An available time allocation later in the day.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

assumed preference

A choice attributed to someone without confirmation.

question an assumed preference

individual variation

Differences among people within the same group.

recognize individual variation

neutral wording

Language that avoids unsupported judgments or assumptions.

use neutral wording

language preference

The language a person chooses for communication.

check language preference

personal space

The distance or privacy a person prefers in an interaction.

respect personal space

service confirmation

Verification that the requested service has been arranged.

await service confirmation

stereotype

A generalized belief applied to an individual because of group membership.

avoid a cultural stereotype

clarifying question

A question resolving a specific ambiguity.

ask a clarifying question

form of address

The name or title used when speaking to someone.

ask the preferred form of address

communication style

A person's preferred manner of interaction.

adapt communication style

interruption

An action that breaks someone's current activity or privacy.

avoid an unnecessary interruption

emergency access

Entry governed by separate urgent-situation procedures.

distinguish emergency access

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

duration of stay DURATION OF STAY

distinguish the duration of stay

Keep the meaning precise: The total period of the guest's visit.

neutral wording NEUTRAL WORDING

use neutral wording

Keep the meaning precise: Language that avoids unsupported judgments or assumptions.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Ask about the service

Would you prefer service later today or no service today?

Clarify the requested option

You would like housekeeping after 14:00 if available.

Avoid an exact-time promise

After 14:00 does not mean a confirmed start at 14:00.

Avoid a group assumption

I will check your preference directly.

Check a future preference

We have not yet discussed the later days.

Offer a clear next step

I will contact the afternoon team and confirm the available option.

Correct the earlier inference

Declining this morning did not mean declining the whole stay.

Bound the policy

Emergency access follows the property's separate rules.

Confirm the time boundary

You would like no routine entry before 14:00 today.

Keep availability honest

I still need to check an afternoon slot.

Limit the period

I will record that for today only.

Use the guest's words

The note should describe the service and timing you requested.

Separate request and confirmation

The request is recorded; the service time is not confirmed.

Respect the interaction

I do not need a personal explanation for that preference.

Keep the record neutral

No routine entry before 14:00 today; later service requested.

Close with a readback

Let me repeat the request so I record it accurately.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Keep availability honest
Useful wording: I still need to check an afternoon slot.

Purpose: Avoid an exact-time promise
Useful wording: After 14:00 does not mean a confirmed start at 14:00.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which note is accurate?

A. No housekeeping for this nationality.

B. Cancel all service for three nights.

C. Service guaranteed at exactly 14:00.

D. No routine entry before 14:00 today; later service requested, slot pending.

2. Which question avoids stereotyping?

A. Why are all your compatriots so private?

B. Would you prefer service later today or no service today?

C. Do people from your country dislike housekeeping?

D. Your nationality means you never need service, correct?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Housekeeping provided while a guest continues a stay. Which term fits?

A. individual variation

B. personal space

C. opt in

D. stayover service

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule". Nico: "I also need to correct our earlier note. It says you declined housekeeping for all three nights. Is that what you intended?" Ms Rahman: [missing response] Nico: "I am sorry; that note went beyond what you asked. I will correct it to today's request only." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Please send me the confirmation once you have it. A recorded request has been mistaken for a booking on another stay.

B. No, not for the whole stay. I only declined this morning. Please do not cancel the other days because of that.

C. Understood. I am asking about routine service, not emergencies. Please let me know if the afternoon team cannot fit me in.

D. Correct. That is a clear, factual note. Thank you for correcting it. I will wait for your message about the afternoon.

Answers and explanations, page 148

> **One useful distinction**
>
> No routine entry before 14:00 today is narrower than no housekeeping for three nights. A request for service after 14:00 does not establish a start at exactly 14:00, nor guarantee that an afternoon slot exists.

E Conversation

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

factual / routine service / preference / time window / privacy / whole stay / afternoon slot / confirmation / housekeeping note / assumption

01 **Nico:** Ms Rahman, may I check your housekeeping request? Would you like service later today, or would you prefer to skip it today?

02 **Ms Rahman:** Later, please. I would like some [1] _____ this morning. Please do not send anyone in before two, but I would still like the room serviced afterward if possible.

03 **Nico:** Certainly. I will ask the afternoon team what they can arrange, then come back to you with an available time.

04 **Ms Rahman:** Thank you. An [2] _____ would work. It does not have to be exactly two. I just do not want another knock before then.

05 **Nico:** I also need to correct our earlier note. It says you declined housekeeping for all three nights. Is that what you intended?

06 **Ms Rahman:** No, not for the [3] _____. I only declined this morning. Please do not cancel the other days because of that.

07 **Nico:** I am sorry; that note went beyond what you asked. I will correct it to today's request only.

08 **Ms Rahman:** Someone also said guests from my country usually want no service. That felt like an [4] _____ about me. Please just ask what I need.

09 **Nico:** You are right. We should have asked you directly. I will keep the note about the service and timing, not your nationality.

10 **Ms Rahman:** Good. My [5] _____ today is a quiet morning and housekeeping later if you have space. That is all I need the team to know.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Nico:** I have entered no routine entry before two today; later housekeeping requested, awaiting the team's reply. Does that describe it correctly?

12 **Ms Rahman:** Yes. Could you make sure the [6] _____ still says I want service later? I do not want the afternoon team to think I refused everything.

13 **Nico:** It does. This covers ordinary housekeeping visits; the hotel's separate emergency procedures are unchanged.

14 **Ms Rahman:** Understood. I am asking about [7] _____, not emergencies. Please let me know if the afternoon team cannot fit me in.

15 **Nico:** I will. I have recorded the request, but I still need their answer before I can say it is arranged.

16 **Ms Rahman:** Please send me the [8] _____ once you have it. A recorded request has been mistaken for a booking on another stay.

17 **Nico:** Certainly. We can check tomorrow's arrangements separately when you know what you would like.

18 **Ms Rahman:** That suits me. I may want a different [9] _____ tomorrow, but I have not decided. Please leave tomorrow's timing open for now.

19 **Nico:** To confirm today's request: no routine visit before two, housekeeping afterward if available, and no change requested for the remaining days.

20 **Ms Rahman:** Correct. That is a clear, [10] _____ note. Thank you for correcting it. I will wait for your message about the afternoon.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. privacy / **2.** afternoon slot / **3.** whole stay / **4.** assumption / **5.** preference / **6.** housekeeping note / **7.** routine service / **8.** confirmation / **9.** time window / **10.** factual

Why these answers fit, page 149

F Check accuracy and scope

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

Return to the case

Ms Rahman declines morning housekeeping on the first day of a three-night stay. A colleague assumes guests from her country never want housekeeping and proposes canceling routine service for the whole stay. Guest-relations agent Nico checks directly. Ms Rahman wants no routine room entry before 14:00 today and would like service after 14:00 if available. The afternoon team has not yet confirmed a slot. Her preference for later days has not been stated. Nico can record today's request and seek confirmation, but cannot promise the time or infer future preferences. Emergency access follows the property's separate rules.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What needs confirmation before promising afternoon service?

A. An available slot from the afternoon team
B. The guest's nationality
C. The employee's general impression
D. A guess based on the empty corridor

2. Which statement about future days is supported?

A. An individual preference cannot ever change.
B. Their service preference remains unstated.
C. Today automatically controls every later day.
D. Three nights means exactly three afternoon services are booked.

Answers and explanations, page 151

Listen for the distinction

Repeat turns 11-16, distinguishing the recorded request from the service confirmation.

Ask without making the guest defend a group

People differ within every nationality and language community. A neutral question about today's service is more useful than an explanation of what people from a country supposedly prefer. Confirm the individual choice, its time period, and whether the requested service is actually available.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A one-day request stays a one-day request

A guest asks for no routine service before 15:00 today and requests later service if available. The team has not confirmed a slot. No preference has been stated for tomorrow.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unstated / availability / 15:00 / stereotype

01 **Agent:** The no-entry boundary is before [1] _____ today.

02 **Guest:** Later service is subject to [2] _____.

03 **Agent:** Tomorrow's preference remains [3] _____.

04 **Guest:** Please record my individual request without a cultural [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 15:00 / **2.** availability / **3.** unstated / **4.** stereotype

Why these answers fit, page 151

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule". Nico: "It does. This covers ordinary housekeeping visits; the hotel's separate emergency procedures are unchanged." Ms Rahman: [missing response] Nico: "I will. I have recorded the request, but I still need their answer before I can say it is arranged." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No, not for the whole stay. I only declined this morning. Please do not cancel the other days because of that.

B. Understood. I am asking about routine service, not emergencies. Please let me know if the afternoon team cannot fit me in.

C. Correct. That is a clear, factual note. Thank you for correcting it. I will wait for your message about the afternoon.

D. Please send me the confirmation once you have it. A recorded request has been mistaken for a booking on another stay.

Answers and explanations, page 152

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Tour Operations and Traveler Safety" and "Cultural Expectations and Service Style". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A temporary restriction preventing the tour from leaving. Which term fits?

A. lightning safety plan
B. restart decision
C. departure hold
D. group accountability

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Choose not to receive a specified optional service. Which term fits?

A. opt out
B. assumed preference
C. language preference
D. service preference

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "A presenter asked whether playback was included. They were worried that the microphone might be checked while the recorded material was left until the session itself." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "Which document should people use? There is an old planning email, my event schedule, and a venue copy with the vague audio note." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. That is our buffer time. It is not an unallocated extra rehearsal slot. Any change that consumes it needs a review of the handover before doors open.
B. That readback captures it. I will send the revised run of show, and you will collect team acknowledgements. We now have an arrangement instead of a shared assumption.
C. The playback feed is part of Vera's confirmed scope. I will put both items in the entry so the presenter and audio team can see the same expectation.
D. No. That assumption was shared without a named owner. We need to replace it with a definite entry, not ask both teams to keep expecting the other to act.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule". Nico: "Certainly. We can check tomorrow's arrangements separately when you know what you would like." Ms Rahman: [missing response] Nico: "To confirm today's request: no routine visit before two, housekeeping afterward if available, and no change requested for the remaining days." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That suits me. I may want a different time window tomorrow, but I have not decided. Please leave tomorrow's timing open for now.

B. Someone also said guests from my country usually want no service. That felt like an assumption about me. Please just ask what I need.

C. Good. My preference today is a quiet morning and housekeeping later if you have space. That is all I need the team to know.

D. Thank you. An afternoon slot would work. It does not have to be exactly two. I just do not want another knock before then.

Answers and explanations, page 162

Language for the next case

The banking app still shows the hotel hold

authorization hold

An authorization hold reserves funds or credit temporarily; its pending display is not proof of a second completed payment.

Idris: Let us check the entries separately. The three hundred fifty appears as an authorization hold, while the two hundred eighty is posted. I will compare that with our payment record.

itemized folio

The itemized folio lists the room, tax, and parking charges, allowing the guest to reconcile the $280 total.

Idris: Here is the itemized folio: room two hundred forty, tax twenty-four, and parking sixteen. There is no minibar charge on this bill.

settled payment

The settled payment is the completed $280 checkout transaction in the supplied record, not the sum of a posted payment and pending authorization.

Idris: Correct. There is one settled payment in our record. The pending entry can still affect what you have available while it is being resolved.

release request

The release request is the hotel's instruction concerning unused authorization; it does not confirm when the issuer will update available funds or its display.

Idris: I can check the release request and provide its recorded details. I cannot control when your card provider updates the account or guarantee that it will happen today.

card issuer

The card issuer maintains the card account and can check how the pending authorization affects it; the hotel cannot promise its processing time.

Idris: Do not send the full screen or card number by ordinary email. Use our secure process for any details needed, and contact your card issuer through its verified contact channel.

available balance

The available balance reflects what the guest can currently use; it can be affected by a hold even when only one payment has settled.

Idris: I will follow up with the verified status. Ask the issuer about your available balance, not just the posted total. If another completed charge appears, let us investigate it rather than assume it is still the same hold.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The banking app still shows the hotel hold

After checkout, a guest sees a $350 pending hotel authorization and a $280 posted payment. The final bill is room $240, supplied tax $24, and parking $16. Hotel records show one completed $280 payment and a request to release the unused authorization. The issuer has not confirmed its display or release timing.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

authorization hold / release request / settled payment / card issuer / available balance / itemized folio

01 **Ms Bennett:** My receipt says two hundred eighty dollars, but my banking app also shows three hundred fifty. Have you charged me twice?

02 **Idris:** Let us check the entries separately. The three hundred fifty appears as an [1] _____, while the two hundred eighty is posted. I will compare that with our payment record.

03 **Ms Bennett:** The larger amount was there when I checked in. I assumed it was the room payment, so I was surprised to see another entry today.

04 **Idris:** Our record shows the check-in authorization and one completed payment at checkout. I understand why the two entries together are concerning.

05 **Ms Bennett:** Can you show what makes up the two hundred eighty? I did not buy anything from the minibar.

06 **Idris:** Here is the [2] _____: room two hundred forty, tax twenty-four, and parking sixteen. There is no minibar charge on this bill.

Conversation / continued

07 **Ms Bennett:** Those add to two hundred eighty. The parking is correct. What happened to the remaining seventy from the larger amount?

08 **Idris:** That difference is not an extra charge on your folio. We have asked for the unused authorization to be released; that is not a seventy-dollar refund of a completed payment.

09 **Ms Bennett:** So your records show two hundred eighty paid, rather than six hundred thirty paid in total?

10 **Idris:** Correct. There is one [3] _____ in our record. The pending entry can still affect what you have available while it is being resolved.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The banking app still shows the hotel hold

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ms Bennett:** I need to use the card for another hotel tonight. Can you remove the pending entry before I get there?

12 **Idris:** I can check the [4] _____ and provide its recorded details. I cannot control when your card provider updates the account or guarantee that it will happen today.

13 **Ms Bennett:** I would appreciate something I can give them. Please do not just tell me to wait without checking whether the request went through.

14 **Idris:** I will verify the request with our payments team and send you the final folio through our approved private channel. We can also supply the relevant transaction reference securely.

15 **Ms Bennett:** Should I send you a screenshot of the entire banking screen? It includes the card number and several other purchases.

16 **Idris:** Do not send the full screen or card number by ordinary email. Use our secure process for any details needed, and contact your [5] _____ through its verified contact channel.

17 **Ms Bennett:** The available amount is lower, even though you say the second entry is pending. That is the part causing the problem for me.

18 **Idris:** I understand. A hold can reduce your available funds or credit without being a second completed charge. We should not dismiss that practical effect.

19 **Ms Bennett:** Please send the verified documents and tell me what the payments team confirms. I will ask my issuer about the pending entry and what I can use tonight.

20 **Idris:** I will follow up with the verified status. Ask the issuer about your [6] _____, not just the posted total. If another completed charge appears, let us investigate it rather than assume it is still the same hold.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. authorization hold / **2.** itemized folio / **3.** settled payment / **4.** release request / **5.** card issuer / **6.** available balance

Why these answers fit, page 164

Do not add pending to posted as a final bill

A guest sees a $220 pending authorization and a $180 posted hotel payment. The itemized final folio totals $180. The hotel has requested release of the unused authorization, but the issuer has not confirmed when it will disappear.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

180 / pending / refund / timing

01 **Guest:** The final itemized bill is [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Agent:** The separate authorization is still labeled [2] _____.

03 **Guest:** The forty-dollar difference is not automatically a cash [3] _____.

04 **Agent:** The issuer must confirm the release [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 180 / **2.** pending / **3.** refund / **4.** timing

Why these answers fit, page 164

Keep the distinction audible

Explain pending and completed card transactions without promising a bank-controlled release time.

Language for the next case

Accessible describes features, not one standard room

specific features

Specific features identify what this guest needs; a general accessible label does not establish the bed or bathing arrangement.

Owen: Let me check those specific features for your dates. I will describe what is verified rather than assume every accessible room is the same.

roll-in shower

The roll-in shower is the verified bathing feature in Room C; a tub with grab bars is not the requested substitute.

Owen: Yes. Room C has two queen beds and a roll-in shower with a fixed seat. Its current feature record confirms both, and it is available for your dates.

layout

The layout shows the arrangement of the bathroom features, helping the guest assess suitability without the agent asking for a diagnosis.

Owen: I can request the current layout and any verified measurements you need. You can tell me which details matter; you do not need to explain a medical diagnosis.

access needs

Access needs concern the practical features the guest requires, not a presumed limitation based on a broad disability label.

Owen: Certainly. Your access needs guide what we verify. I will keep the actual features in the reservation notes, not substitute a general label.

reservation

The reservation is the actual booking, distinct from an availability discussion; it will be completed after the requested details and the guest's decision.

Owen: That is fine. This conversation has confirmed availability, but it has not yet completed your reservation. I will make that status clear in my message.

bed configuration

The bed configuration is two separate queen beds in Room C, which must be preserved together with the requested shower features.

Owen: Understood. The bed configuration and shower requirements are linked in this request. I will follow up with the missing information so you can make an informed choice.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Accessible describes features, not one standard room

Ms Diaz needs two separate beds and a roll-in shower with a fixed seat. For her dates, the hotel has verified Room A with one king bed and a roll-in shower, Room B with two beds and a tub, and Room C with two queen beds and the requested shower and seat. Room C is available.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

roll-in shower / reservation / access needs / layout / bed configuration / specific features

01 **Ms Diaz:** Your website lists several accessible rooms, but I cannot tell which has two beds and a roll-in shower with a fixed seat.

02 **Owen:** Let me check those [1] _____ for your dates. I will describe what is verified rather than assume every accessible room is the same.

03 **Ms Diaz:** Thank you. I am traveling with a companion, so one king bed will not work. We need separate beds.

04 **Owen:** Room A has a roll-in shower but one king bed. That does not meet the bed requirement. Room B has two beds, but its bathroom has a tub.

05 **Ms Diaz:** A tub with grab bars would not replace the shower I asked for. Is there a room with both features together?

06 **Owen:** Yes. Room C has two queen beds and a [2] _____ with a fixed seat. Its current feature record confirms both, and it is available for your dates.

07 **Ms Diaz:** That sounds right. I also need to know whether there is a step-free route from the entrance to that room.

08 **Owen:** I will verify the route details with our on-site team before you decide. I have the room features, but I do not want to invent information about the route.

09 **Ms Diaz:** Could you also send the bathroom layout? A description of accessible does not tell me where the seat is in relation to the controls.

10 **Owen:** I can request the current [3] _____ and any verified measurements you need. You can tell me which details matter; you do not need to explain a medical diagnosis.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Accessible describes features, not one standard room

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ms Diaz:** Please check the seat and control positions. I will assess whether the layout works for me from that information.

12 **Owen:** Certainly. Your [4] _____ guide what we verify. I will keep the actual features in the reservation notes, not substitute a general label.

13 **Ms Diaz:** If I reserve it, could another guest be given that room and leave me with the tub room at check-in?

14 **Owen:** We must preserve the confirmed required features in the booking. I will follow the room-blocking process, not treat either of the other room types as an equivalent replacement.

15 **Ms Diaz:** Please send the route and layout details first. Once I have checked them, I would like to complete the booking for Room C.

16 **Owen:** That is fine. This conversation has confirmed availability, but it has not yet completed your [5] _____. I will make that status clear in my message.

17 **Ms Diaz:** And please show the room rate and cancellation terms in that message too. I need the same booking information as for any other room.

18 **Owen:** Of course. I will include the verified features, the requested route and layout information once checked, and the applicable rate and terms together.

19 **Ms Diaz:** Good. Do not switch me to a one-bed room to preserve the shower, or a tub room to preserve the beds. I need both.

20 **Owen:** Understood. The [6] _____ and shower requirements are linked in this request. I will follow up with the missing information so you can make an informed choice.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. specific features / **2.** roll-in shower / **3.** layout / **4.** access needs / **5.** reservation / **6.** bed configuration

Why these answers fit, page 166

Check the combination, not the label

A guest requires two separate beds and a roll-in shower. Room 1 has one king bed and that shower. Room 2 has two beds and a tub. Available Room 3 has two beds and a roll-in shower. Route information still needs checking before the guest decides.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

combination / route / 3 / reservation

01 **Agent:** The verified feature match is Room [1] _____.

02 **Guest:** Two beds with a tub are not an equivalent [2] _____.

03 **Agent:** The remaining information concerns the [3] _____.

04 **Guest:** Availability alone does not complete my [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 3 / **2.** combination / **3.** route / **4.** reservation

Why these answers fit, page 166

Keep the distinction audible

Check a guest's required features and complete a reservation without substituting assumptions.

Language for the next case

Room and tax to the organizer, extras to the guest

master account

The master account is the organizer's group billing account; the agreement permits room and tax there, not every guest charge.

Cal: Yes. The master account is receiving all charge codes at present. That is wider than the signed billing instructions.

individual folio

The individual folio should carry the guest's $20 parking and $30 breakfast charges, totaling $50 in this supplied example.

Cal: Understood. The individual folio should carry fifty dollars. I will keep the two-night room amounts separate from the supplied total extras.

routing instructions

Routing instructions define which charge categories go to which account; existing postings also need checking rather than assuming an edit moves them correctly.

Cal: I will check both. The routing instructions need correction, and the existing postings must be reviewed under our system's adjustment process.

audit trail

The audit trail records the original postings and authorized transfers, so the corrected payer split remains explainable without deleting charges.

Cal: I will preserve the audit trail and use the approved correction method. We should not delete the extras and re-enter an unexplained lump sum.

billing dispute

A billing dispute records disagreement about who should pay or what is due; it should be reviewed without presenting unverified approval as fact.

Cal: Yes. We can say room and tax are covered by the organizer, with these listed extras payable individually. If the guest raises a billing dispute, we will record it and seek the required decision.

charge transfer

The charge transfer moves the $50 extras to the proper unpaid guest folio while preserving the $380 total and the recorded history.

Cal: That reconciles. I will complete the charge transfer and verify the revised statements before settlement. The corrected instructions must also reach the next cashier.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Room and tax to the organizer, extras to the guest

A fictional group agreement makes the organizer responsible for room and supplied room tax only. Each guest pays parking and breakfast. One two-night folio shows room $150 per night, tax $15 per night, parking $20 total, and breakfast $30 total. The current routing incorrectly sends everything to the organizer. No payment has been settled.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

billing dispute / individual folio / audit trail / master account / routing instructions / charge transfer

01 **Inez:** The organizer's draft bill includes parking and breakfast. Our agreement says room and tax only. Could we check the routing before checkout?

02 **Cal:** Yes. The [1] _____ is receiving all charge codes at present. That is wider than the signed billing instructions.

03 **Inez:** For this reservation, the room is one hundred fifty per night for two nights, with fifteen tax each night.

04 **Cal:** That makes three hundred in room charges and thirty in room tax. The organizer's share should be three hundred thirty for this guest.

05 **Inez:** Parking is twenty total and breakfast is thirty total. Those are guest-paid, not thirty dollars of breakfast on each night.

06 **Cal:** Understood. The [2] _____ should carry fifty dollars. I will keep the two-night room amounts separate from the supplied total extras.

Conversation / continued

07 **Inez:** The total bill is still three hundred eighty. We are changing who pays, not removing the parking or breakfast charge.

08 **Cal:** Exactly. The revised split must reconcile to the same total. A transfer between folios is not a discount or a refund.

09 **Inez:** Will changing the instructions affect only tonight's new charges, or also the items already posted on this draft?

10 **Cal:** I will check both. The [3] _____ need correction, and the existing postings must be reviewed under our system's adjustment process.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Room and tax to the organizer, extras to the guest

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Inez:** Please retain a record of the transfer. The organizer will ask why the revised statement differs from the draft they saw this morning.

12 **Cal:** I will preserve the [4] _____ and use the approved correction method. We should not delete the extras and re-enter an unexplained lump sum.

13 **Inez:** One guest says their manager told them breakfast would be covered. I do not have written approval changing the group agreement.

14 **Cal:** We will refer that discrepancy to the authorized group contact. I cannot expand the master-account scope based on an unverified verbal message.

15 **Inez:** For now, can reception explain the written arrangement at checkout without making the guest feel accused of charging the wrong account?

16 **Cal:** Yes. We can say room and tax are covered by the organizer, with these listed extras payable individually. If the guest raises a [5] _____, we will record it and seek the required decision.

17 **Inez:** No money has been taken yet. Please do not call the fifty-dollar correction a refund in the email to the organizer.

18 **Cal:** Agreed. It is a correction to the unpaid folio allocation. We will issue the appropriate final statements once the split and any dispute are resolved.

19 **Inez:** Read back this one for me: three hundred thirty to the organizer, fifty to the guest, three hundred eighty altogether.

20 **Cal:** That reconciles. I will complete the [6] _____ and verify the revised statements before settlement. The corrected instructions must also reach the next cashier.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. master account / **2.** individual folio / **3.** routing instructions / **4.** audit trail / **5.** billing dispute / **6.** charge transfer

Why these answers fit, page 168

A payer change does not change the total

An unpaid two-night bill has room $120 per night, room tax $12 per night, and guest-paid parking $18 total. The organizer covers room and tax only. No other charges apply.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

18 / refund / 264 / 282

01 **Coordinator:** The organizer pays [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Cashier:** The guest pays [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Coordinator:** The combined bill remains [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Cashier:** Changing the unpaid allocation is not a [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 264 / **2.** 18 / **3.** 282 / **4.** refund

Why these answers fit, page 168

Keep the distinction audible

Translate group billing instructions into accurate charge routing and a reconciled readback.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What did the confirmation establish?

A. The early-arrival request was recorded.

The wording recorded the request but did not confirm early access.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What can Arun provide now?

B. Complimentary luggage storage and lobby seating

The brief confirms these two immediate services, not a room or financial remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What does the 13:00 commitment concern?

B. A personal status update

Arun controls the update; no room-ready time has been verified.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which reply handles the misunderstanding best?

A. I see why you expected noon access; the request was recorded, but no room is released yet.

The correct reply acknowledges the expectation and preserves the verified room status.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which promise is within Arun's stated control?

D. I will update you at 13:00 even if we are still waiting.

The brief authorizes a status update, not a room guarantee or financial remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A preference or need submitted with a booking. Which term fits?

A. special request

A Correct. special request: A preference or need submitted with a booking. The usual combination is "record a special request".

B Not here. luggage storage: A service holding bags before or after room use. The usual combination is "offer luggage storage".

C Not here. duty manager: The manager responsible during a particular shift. The usual combination is "consult the duty manager".

D Not here. service recovery: Action to address a disappointing service experience. The usual combination is "coordinate service recovery".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "An early-arrival request sounded like a promise". Ms Vega: "Is there no possibility of a room before three? Should I leave and return later?" Arun: [missing response] Ms Vega: "Another hotel promised twenty minutes, and I waited nearly two hours. I would prefer an honest answer to another guess." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I cannot rule out earlier availability, but I do not have a verified room-ready time. No room has been released yet, so I should not give you an estimate as a promise.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Ms Vega says: "Please store the bags. I still need to decide whether to get something to eat nearby. How will I know whether anything has changed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ms Vega says: "All right. I will stay in the lobby until then. Please do not send me to several departments to ask the same question again." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ms Vega says: "Another hotel promised twenty minutes, and I waited nearly two hours. I would prefer an honest answer to another guess." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 6. It connects Ms Vega's preceding point with Ms Vega's follow-up. The room-ready time remains unknown; the agent must not replace that uncertainty with a guessed promise.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. frustration

Turn 2. Frustration acknowledges the effect of the unclear message without claiming that noon access was actually guaranteed.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. early-arrival request

Turn 4. The request was recorded with the booking, but recording it did not establish guaranteed early access.

3. room-ready time

Turn 6. The room-ready time remains unknown; the agent must not replace that uncertainty with a guessed promise.

4. complimentary

Turn 8. Complimentary means the luggage storage is available without an additional charge, not that the entire stay is free.

5. status update

Turn 10. A status update communicates the current position; it is the action Arun can reliably commit to at thirteen hundred.

6. front desk

Turn 12. The front desk is the reception point where Arun remains responsible for communicating the next update.

7. duty manager

Turn 14. The duty manager is the appropriate person to review the communication concern and any remedy beyond Arun's authority.

8. review

Turn 16. Review means the request will be considered; it does not mean compensation has already been authorized.

9. claim ticket

Turn 18. The claim ticket identifies the stored bags and supports their later retrieval.

10. follow-through

Turn 20. Follow-through means carrying out the promised check and update, not merely making a reassuring statement.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement accurately explains complimentary storage?

D. We can hold your luggage without an additional charge.

Complimentary describes the storage charge only, not the wider booking terms.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F2. What should Arun do if compensation is requested?

D. Refer the request for the duty manager's review.

Arun lacks personal authority to approve compensation but can seek the appropriate review.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. room access

Guest: Is noon a guaranteed time for room access?

Turn 1. The question concerns entry, which remains unconfirmed despite the scheduled update.

2. update

Agent: No; noon is the time for my update.

Turn 2. The agent controls the noon communication, not the unverified room release.

3. luggage

Guest: Can you hold my luggage while I wait?

Turn 3. Storage of the guest's bags is the immediate confirmed service.

4. complimentary

Agent: Yes, that service is complimentary.

Turn 4. The brief explicitly states that luggage storage is free.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An early-arrival request sounded like a promise". Ms Vega: "Please also review that email. It sounded as though my early arrival had been approved." Arun: [missing response] Ms Vega: "Would the manager be able to consider some compensation for the inconvenience? I understand that you may not be the person who can decide." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will pass that concern to the duty manager. I can describe the wording you received and the expectation it created, without suggesting that you caused the misunderstanding.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Ms Vega says: "Would the manager be able to consider some compensation for the inconvenience? I understand that you may not be the person who can decide." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Ms Vega says: "Thank you. I will wait here until one, then decide about lunch. Please come and find me even if the room is still not ready." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Ms Vega says: "I have been traveling since early this morning. I would have planned differently if I had known I might be waiting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 14. It connects Ms Vega's preceding point with Ms Vega's follow-up. The duty manager is the appropriate person to review the communication concern and any remedy beyond Arun's authority.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is established about the noise complaint?

C. It has been reported but not yet checked.

The brief supplies an unverified complaint, not a completed investigation or remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. Which information should be removed from the public draft?

D. Room number, stay dates, and booking reference

These booking details belong in the appropriate private process, not the public reply.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. What may an approved remedy depend on here?

D. The outcome of the service review and applicable policy

The fictional policy makes remedies independent of whether the guest changes the review.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which public reply is most appropriate?

B. We are sorry to hear about the noise concern; please contact our published guest-relations channel so we can review it.

The correct reply acknowledges the concern and offers a private next step without inventing findings.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Which internal note is suitably neutral?

D. The guest reports late-night noise; verification is pending.

It distinguishes the reported experience from the pending factual review.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A report of unwanted or disruptive sound. Which term fits?

D. noise complaint

A Not here. factual check: Verification of a claim against relevant information. The usual combination is "complete a factual check".

B Not here. booking reference: An identifier for a particular reservation. The usual combination is "protect the booking reference".

C Not here. reputational risk: The possibility of damage to public trust. The usual combination is "reduce reputational risk".

D Correct. noise complaint: A report of unwanted or disruptive sound. The usual combination is "investigate a noise complaint".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "No, not yet. I used the original complaint and my colleague's impression of the conversation. That is not enough to establish whether the reported noise occurred." Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "Could the reply say that we are sorry to hear the stay was disappointing, then invite the guest to contact our published guest-relations channel?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Then describe it as guest feedback awaiting review. Do not call the account false, and do not claim that we have already proved a service failure. Neither conclusion is established.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Elise says: "I included the room number and stay dates to show that we know the booking. I also said the guest exaggerated what happened that night." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Mateo's response in turn 6. It connects Elise's preceding point with Elise's follow-up. Guest feedback identifies the reported experience without pretending that its factual review is already complete.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Elise says: "I can handle the follow-up. Once the guest contacts us privately, I will confirm the necessary booking information through our approved process and review the available records." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Elise says: "Could you check my response to the noise review before I publish it? I was frustrated by the guest's description." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

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02 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. public reply

Turn 2. A public reply is visible beyond the original reviewer, so its wording must suit the wider audience.

2. booking reference

Turn 4. The booking reference and other reservation details should not be exposed in the public response.

3. guest feedback

Turn 6. Guest feedback identifies the reported experience without pretending that its factual review is already complete.

4. acknowledgement

Turn 8. An acknowledgement recognizes the concern and does not by itself confirm every allegation or approve a remedy.

5. defensive tone

Turn 10. A defensive tone shifts attention from helping with the complaint to protecting the property from criticism.

6. incident log

Turn 12. The incident log may contain relevant reports and actions; it is a source to check, not a presumed verdict.

7. conditional offer

Turn 14. The proposed credit is improperly conditional on removing the review rather than on the service-review outcome.

8. service remedy

Turn 16. A service remedy is an authorized response to the service problem, not an outcome already decided by acknowledging the complaint.

9. case record

Turn 18. The case record should track responsibility, relevant facts, and actions so the private review does not lose continuity.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. resolution status

Turn 20. Resolution status records where the complaint actually stands; posting a reply is not the same as resolving it.

Return to the conversation, page 20

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which proposal should be rejected?

D. Offer a credit only if the guest removes the review.

Linking a benefit to review removal improperly conditions service recovery on the review.

Return to the exercise, page 24

F2. What does posting the public reply establish?

D. The concern has received an acknowledgement and a next step.

A public acknowledgement does not itself establish investigation, remedy, or acceptance.

Return to the exercise, page 24

F / Guided speaking

1. reservation code

Manager: Remove the reservation code from the public response.

Turn 1. The reservation identifier is private booking information, not necessary public reply content.

2. acknowledgement

Agent: We can give a courteous acknowledgement now.

Turn 2. Recognition of the concern is appropriate before the factual review is complete.

3. factual check

Manager: The complaint still needs a factual check.

Turn 3. The brief states that no investigation has yet been completed.

4. deletion

Agent: Any approved voucher must be independent of review deletion.

Turn 4. A service remedy must not be conditional on removing the review.

Return to the conversation, page 25

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "The handover suggests a credit, but only after the review comes down. We cannot use that condition, can we?" Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "Understood. I will not promise compensation in the initial reply either. We still need to check the facts and determine what our policy permits." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Do not make that conditional offer. Any approved remedy must stand independently of review removal or revision. Our task is to address the service concern, not purchase a different public account.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Elise says: "No, not yet. I used the original complaint and my colleague's impression of the conversation. That is not enough to establish whether the reported noise occurred." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Mateo's response in turn 14. It connects Elise's preceding point with Elise's follow-up. The proposed credit is improperly conditional on removing the review rather than on the service-review outcome.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Elise says: "Could the reply say that we are sorry to hear the stay was disappointing, then invite the guest to contact our published guest-relations channel?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Elise says: "I can handle the follow-up. Once the guest contacts us privately, I will confirm the necessary booking information through our approved process and review the available records." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 25

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which alternative preserves the booked bed arrangement?

B. The king room at Harbor Hotel

Harbor Hotel has the verified king-bed alternative; the on-site room has two separate beds.

Return to the exercise, page 28

A2. What costs are approved for the off-site option?

D. The room-price difference and transfer

The brief limits the approved package to the room-price difference and transfer.

Return to the exercise, page 28

A3. Has the guest accepted an alternative?

C. No; his choice is still required.

Both alternatives are available, but the guest has not selected one.

Return to the exercise, page 28

D / Response choices

D1. Which description is most accurate?

D. The twin room is on-site but has two separate beds.

The correct description preserves the verified difference in bed configuration.

Return to the exercise, page 32

D2. Which statement overpromises?

B. We will pay every expense you incur.

The approval does not extend to every incidental or future expense.

Return to the exercise, page 32

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The number and arrangement of beds. Which term fits?

A. bed configuration

A Correct. bed configuration: The number and arrangement of beds. The usual combination is "explain the bed configuration".

B Not here. arrival instructions: Directions for reaching or entering the receiving property. The usual combination is "provide arrival instructions".

C Not here. alternative accommodation: A substitute place to stay. The usual combination is "verify alternative accommodation".

D Not here. transfer: Transport between locations. The usual combination is "arrange the approved transfer".

Return to the exercise, page 32

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The booked room type is unavailable". Mr Chen: "That difference matters to us. What is the second option, and have you actually checked that the other hotel can provide the right room tonight?" Sofia: [missing response] Mr Chen: "Would I have to pay the difference? I do not want to arrive there and discover that this solution costs more than the booking I made." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The receiving property is Harbor Hotel nearby. They have confirmed that a king room is available tonight. That preserves the bed type, although it changes where you will stay.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Mr Chen says: "That is fine. Before we leave, please give us the receiving contact and explain what we should show when we arrive at Harbor Hotel." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Mr Chen says: "Then we choose the king room at Harbor Hotel for tonight. Please confirm the actual reservation before we leave with the luggage." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sofia's response in turn 6. It connects Mr Chen's preceding point with Mr Chen's follow-up. The receiving property is Harbor Hotel, which has verified the relevant accommodation for tonight.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Mr Chen says: "Please start with the option here. We would prefer not to move unless staying means losing the bed arrangement that we specifically booked." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 32

E / Conversation

1. room type

Turn 2. Room type identifies the accommodation category that cannot be supplied tonight, rather than suggesting the entire reservation never existed.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. twin room

Turn 4. A twin room has two separate beds and therefore does not preserve the guest's booked king-bed arrangement.

3. receiving property

Turn 6. The receiving property is Harbor Hotel, which has verified the relevant accommodation for tonight.

4. rate difference

Turn 8. The rate difference is the additional room-price amount the original property has specifically approved paying.

5. consent

Turn 10. Consent means the guest agrees to the specific alternative after hearing the differences and approved costs.

6. booking amendment

Turn 12. The booking amendment records the guest's selected change; it is distinct from merely identifying an available alternative.

7. relocation

Turn 14. Relocation means accommodation at another property; the approved transfer means the guest is not simply told to walk there.

8. transfer

Turn 16. The transfer is the transport arrangement, which requires its own confirmation even though the room option is available.

9. arrival instructions

Turn 18. Arrival instructions make the receiving handover practical by explaining where to go and what booking information is needed.

10. readback

Turn 20. A readback repeats the agreed details so both parties can correct any misunderstanding before the relocation is carried out.

Return to the conversation, page 34

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should happen before changing the booking?

A. Explain the alternatives and obtain the guest's choice.

The guest has not selected an alternative and needs accurate information before agreeing.

Return to the exercise, page 37

F2. Which handover is complete in principle?

B. Verify the chosen booking, receiving contact, arrival details, and approved transfer.

A practical relocation requires coordination of the selected accommodation and its agreed supporting arrangements.

Return to the exercise, page 37

F / Guided speaking

1. bed configuration

Agent: The local option has a different bed configuration.

Turn 1. Two singles differ from the king bed originally booked.

2. king bed

Guest: The nearby option preserves the king bed.

Turn 2. The verified nearby room contains the requested king bed.

3. transport

Agent: Our offer includes the price difference and transport.

Turn 3. These are the two costs explicitly approved in the scenario.

4. booking

Guest: Please confirm the details before changing my booking.

Turn 4. A change should follow informed agreement and completed coordination.

Return to the conversation, page 38

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The booked room type is unavailable". Mr Chen: "A member of staff used the word walk earlier. Does that mean we are expected to walk there with our bags? That would be difficult." Sofia: [missing response] Mr Chen: "Do you have a transport departure time yet? Should we stay by reception or wait somewhere else?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No. That is internal shorthand for relocation. In your case, the approved offer includes transport. I should have explained the arrangement in ordinary language instead of leaving that term unclear.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Mr Chen says: "Please start with the option here. We would prefer not to move unless staying means losing the bed arrangement that we specifically booked." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Mr Chen says: "That difference matters to us. What is the second option, and have you actually checked that the other hotel can provide the right room tonight?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Mr Chen says: "Then we choose the king room at Harbor Hotel for tonight. Please confirm the actual reservation before we leave with the luggage." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sofia's response in turn 14. It connects Mr Chen's preceding point with Mr Chen's follow-up. Relocation means accommodation at another property; the approved transfer means the guest is not simply told to walk there.

Return to the exercise, page 38

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is Night B's average daily rate?

A. $120

Room revenue of $7,200 divided by sixty sold rooms equals $120.

Return to the exercise, page 39

A2. What is Night B's revenue per available room?

B. $72

The denominator is all one hundred available rooms, giving seventy-two dollars.

Return to the exercise, page 39

A3. What cannot be calculated from the supplied figures?

A. Profit

Costs are not supplied, so room revenue measures do not establish profit.

Return to the exercise, page 39

D / Response choices

D1. Which summary is accurate?

B. ADR rose while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue fell.

The supplied calculations show higher sold-room rate but lower volume and capacity-based revenue.

Return to the exercise, page 43

D2. Which calculation gives Night A's RevPAR?

A. $8,000 divided by 100

RevPAR divides room revenue by available room supply, not sold rooms.

Return to the exercise, page 43

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Revenue from selling guest rooms. Which term fits?

B. room revenue

A Not here. forecast occupancy: The estimated share of rooms expected to sell. The usual combination is "revise forecast occupancy".

B Correct. room revenue: Revenue from selling guest rooms. The usual combination is "distinguish room revenue".

C Not here. competitive set: A selected group of properties used for comparison. The usual combination is "review the competitive set".

D Not here. revenue management: Coordinating price and availability to manage revenue. The usual combination is "review revenue management".

Return to the exercise, page 43

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "So the first average is one hundred dollars per sold room, and the second is one hundred and twenty. That is a twenty-percent increase." Mina: [missing response] Owen: "I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Correct. Meanwhile, occupancy moved from eighty percent to sixty percent. That is a fall of twenty percentage points, or twenty-five percent relative to the original eighty-percent level.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "Our average rate went up on the second night, so I have called it a complete commercial improvement. Is there anything missing from that summary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Owen says: "That means an eight-dollar reduction per available room. Relative to eighty dollars, it is ten percent lower, despite the higher average selling rate." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 6. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Occupancy is rooms sold divided by available rooms, giving eighty percent on Night A and sixty percent on Night B.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Owen says: "I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 43

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04 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. ADR

Turn 2. ADR measures average room revenue among sold rooms, so it can rise while overall room revenue falls.

2. rooms available

Turn 4. Rooms available is the common supply denominator, which stayed at one hundred on both nights.

3. occupancy

Turn 6. Occupancy is rooms sold divided by available rooms, giving eighty percent on Night A and sixty percent on Night B.

4. RevPAR

Turn 8. RevPAR uses all available rooms as the denominator, producing eighty dollars on Night A and seventy-two on Night B.

5. room revenue

Turn 10. Room revenue fell from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred dollars, the same ten-percent decline with unchanged supply.

6. cost figures

Turn 12. Cost figures are needed before a revenue comparison can support a conclusion about profit.

7. non-room revenue

Turn 14. Non-room revenue is outside the supplied room-only figures, so no total-property revenue conclusion is established.

8. price elasticity

Turn 16. Price elasticity concerns how demand responds to price; two uncontrolled nights do not establish that response.

9. channel mix

Turn 18. Channel mix identifies how sales are distributed across booking routes and can add context to revenue and distribution-cost analysis.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. trade-off

Turn 20. The trade-off is the higher average rate alongside fewer sold rooms, without asserting a proven cause or profit outcome.

Return to the conversation, page 45

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which occupancy change is correctly stated?

C. A fall of 20 percentage points

Eighty percent minus sixty percent is twenty points; the relative fall is twenty-five percent.

Return to the exercise, page 49

F2. Which causal claim is justified by these two nights alone?

B. None; further evidence is needed to isolate a pricing effect.

The comparison reports outcomes but does not control other influences on demand.

Return to the exercise, page 49

F / Guided speaking

1. 80

Analyst: Occupancy is 80 percent.

Turn 1. Forty sold rooms divided by fifty available rooms equals eighty percent.

2. 150

Manager: ADR is 150 dollars.

Turn 2. Six thousand dollars divided by forty sold rooms equals one hundred fifty.

3. 120

Analyst: RevPAR is 120 dollars.

Turn 3. Six thousand dollars divided by fifty available rooms equals one hundred twenty.

4. profit

Manager: We cannot calculate profit from these figures alone.

Turn 4. The case supplies revenue but no relevant cost figures.

Return to the conversation, page 50

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "Fair point. What about restaurant and event spending? Those could change the property's total revenue even when the room figures move in the opposite direction." Mina: [missing response] Owen: "Can I say the price increase caused the occupancy fall, or do we need to look at the business mix first?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. They could, but non-room revenue is not included in this comparison. We should label the scope clearly instead of using the room result as a complete measure of hotel performance.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Owen says: "Start with the room supply. I do not want to mistake a capacity change for performance." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Owen says: "I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "Our average rate went up on the second night, so I have called it a complete commercial improvement. Is there anything missing from that summary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 14. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Non-room revenue is outside the supplied room-only figures, so no total-property revenue conclusion is established.

Return to the exercise, page 50

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is missing for Room 417?

A. Maintenance clearance and final release

Housekeeping is complete, but the repair remains open and release is unrecorded.

Return to the exercise, page 53

A2. Which room can reception assign on the supplied facts?

A. Room 419

Room 419 is released and its required features match the guest's needs.

Return to the exercise, page 53

A3. Who performs the final release in this fictional process?

B. The duty manager

The brief explicitly assigns final release to the duty manager after both clearances.

Return to the exercise, page 53

D / Response choices

D1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Assign 419; keep 417 on hold until its required clearances and release are recorded.

The released and suitable alternative meets the guest need without bypassing 417's outstanding requirements.

Return to the exercise, page 57

D2. What does the housekeeping inspection prove here?

D. The housekeeping checks are complete.

A department-specific inspection does not establish another department's clearance or final authorization.

Return to the exercise, page 57

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A recorded request or instruction for maintenance work. Which term fits?

D. work order

A Not here. room status: The recorded operational condition of a room. The usual combination is "reconcile room status".

B Not here. occupied room: A room currently assigned for guest use. The usual combination is "identify an occupied room".

C Not here. release hold: A restriction preventing a room from being assigned. The usual combination is "maintain the release hold".

D Correct. work order: A recorded request or instruction for maintenance work. The usual combination is "update a work order".

Return to the exercise, page 57

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Clean does not yet mean released". Leah: "I see an open work order for the lock. Could it simply be an old entry that someone forgot to close after finishing the repair?" Marco: [missing response] Leah: "The guest is still at the desk. Is 419 released, and does it match the booking? I would rather offer a confirmed alternative now." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. It could need checking, but the work order is still open. We cannot turn that possibility into a completed repair. Ask the responsible team for the recorded status.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Leah says: "I will put both statuses in the handover. The next shift needs to see why 417 says clean on one screen but unavailable on the other." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Leah says: "Once the repair is cleared, does reception release 417 directly, or does the duty manager still need to record the final decision?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Leah says: "Housekeeping says Room 417 is clean. The guest is waiting, so can I assign it now? The desk needs a clear answer before issuing keys." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Marco's response in turn 6. It connects Leah's preceding point with Leah's follow-up. The work order is the maintenance record requiring verification; its possible staleness is not proof the repair is complete.

Return to the exercise, page 57

E / Conversation

1. release hold

Turn 2. The release hold prevents assignment while the required maintenance clearance and final authorization remain outstanding.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. housekeeping clearance

Turn 4. Housekeeping clearance covers housekeeping's checks and cannot stand in for maintenance clearance or the final room release.

3. work order

Turn 6. The work order is the maintenance record requiring verification; its possible staleness is not proof the repair is complete.

4. maintenance clearance

Turn 8. Maintenance clearance is already recorded for 419, alongside its housekeeping clearance and final release.

5. room assignment

Turn 10. The room assignment concerns 419 only; providing that alternative does not change the unresolved status of 417.

6. release authorization

Turn 12. Release authorization is the missing operational permission, which can be described without guessing at the technical fault or repair time.

7. status reconciliation

Turn 14. Status reconciliation checks what each label means and resolves the records without automatically treating different department statuses as contradictions.

8. handover log

Turn 16. The handover log transfers the actual room assignment, unresolved item, and responsibility to the next shift.

9. return to service

Turn 18. Return to service requires the stated final release after both department clearances; reception does not bypass that step.

10. readback

Turn 20. The readback confirms the room numbers, hold, and release sequence so the two departments act on the same information.

Return to the conversation, page 59

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement about room-status codes is safest?

D. Check the property's definitions and release rules.

Local status definitions and the stated release process determine their operational meaning.

Return to the exercise, page 62

F2. Which response avoids blaming a team?

C. Maintenance clearance is pending; I will check the responsible contact.

It states the actionable status and next step without an unsupported general accusation.

Return to the exercise, page 62

F / Guided speaking

1. 210

Reception: The released alternative is Room 210.

Turn 1. The brief identifies 210 as released and suitable for the booking.

2. maintenance

Coordinator: Room 208 still lacks maintenance clearance.

Turn 2. Only housekeeping clearance has been recorded for Room 208.

3. release

Reception: It also needs the manager's final release.

Turn 3. The local process requires a separate final manager authorization.

4. unavailable

Coordinator: Keep 208 unavailable until those requirements are met.

Turn 4. Assignment must wait for the outstanding clearance and release.

Return to the conversation, page 63

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Clean does not yet mean released". Leah: "I will put both statuses in the handover. The next shift needs to see why 417 says clean on one screen but unavailable on the other." Marco: [missing response] Leah: "For the handover, I will record 419 as the assigned room and 417 as unavailable, with its lock work order still open pending verification." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That calls for status reconciliation. The labels may describe different checks rather than contradictory facts. Confirm their definitions and ensure reception sees whether final release has actually occurred.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Leah says: "Housekeeping says Room 417 is clean. The guest is waiting, so can I assign it now? The desk needs a clear answer before issuing keys." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Leah says: "Once the repair is cleared, does reception release 417 directly, or does the duty manager still need to record the final decision?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Leah says: "I see an open work order for the lock. Could it simply be an old entry that someone forgot to close after finishing the repair?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Marco's response in turn 14. It connects Leah's preceding point with Leah's follow-up. Status reconciliation checks what each label means and resolves the records without automatically treating different department statuses as contradictions.

Return to the exercise, page 63

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What was missing from the earlier soundcheck arrangement?

D. Confirmed time, room, and owner

Both teams assumed the other had arranged the task, leaving these details unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 64

A2. How long is the confirmed soundcheck slot?

D. Thirty minutes

The slot runs from 10:30 until 11:00, a thirty-minute duration.

Return to the exercise, page 64

A3. What buffer remains before doors open?

D. Fifteen minutes

Soundcheck finishes at 11:00 and doors open at 11:15.

Return to the exercise, page 64

D / Response choices

D1. Which schedule entry is complete?

A. Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30-11:00, Vera, microphone and playback feed.

Only the complete entry preserves all confirmed details: location, interval, named owner, and test scope.

Return to the exercise, page 68

D2. What happens if soundcheck ends at 11:15 with doors unchanged?

B. The fifteen-minute buffer disappears.

The revised finish coincides with admission, leaving no transition buffer.

Return to the exercise, page 68

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The audio signal from recorded material into the system. Which term fits?

C. playback feed

A Not here. task owner: The person accountable for completing a specified activity. The usual combination is "name the task owner".

B Not here. load-out: Taking equipment out after the event. The usual combination is "confirm the load-out".

C Correct. playback feed: The audio signal from recorded material into the system. The usual combination is "test the playback feed".

D Not here. stage manager: The person coordinating actions around the stage. The usual combination is "brief the stage manager".

Return to the exercise, page 68

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "Please replace technical team with Vera on the schedule. I want the presenter to know exactly who is meeting them in Room A." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Vera will be listed as the task owner. I will also include Room A and both times. A start time alone would not show when the space must be ready for the next activity.

A Correct. This is Ren's response in turn 6. It connects Asha's preceding point with Asha's follow-up. The task owner is the named person who has accepted responsibility, avoiding an ambiguous department-level assignment.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Asha says: "Which document should people use? There is an old planning email, my event schedule, and a venue copy with the vague audio note." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Asha says: "My team expected the venue to arrange the soundcheck. Your schedule just says audio before doors. Do we have a confirmed room and time anywhere?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Asha says: "If Vera later needs more time, should she simply edit the finish in the shared document, or contact us before changing the schedule?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 68

E / Conversation

1. assumption

Turn 2. The assumption is the unverified belief that another team had arranged the soundcheck; it left essential details unconfirmed.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. soundcheck

Turn 4. The soundcheck is the scheduled audio test Vera will conduct in the verified room and time slot.

3. task owner

Turn 6. The task owner is the named person who has accepted responsibility, avoiding an ambiguous department-level assignment.

4. buffer time

Turn 8. Buffer time is the fifteen-minute interval between the eleven o'clock soundcheck finish and eleven-fifteen audience admission.

5. playback feed

Turn 10. The playback feed is explicitly included alongside the event microphone in Vera's soundcheck scope.

6. run of show

Turn 12. The run of show is the shared timed event record that should carry the current soundcheck details.

7. acknowledgement

Turn 14. Acknowledgement confirms that the update reached the relevant teams; sending it alone does not establish that shared awareness.

8. change control

Turn 16. Change control requires reviewing and communicating the effect of a later adjustment rather than silently changing a dependent schedule.

9. Doors open

Turn 18. Doors open identifies the audience-admission time, which is eleven fifteen rather than the eleven o'clock technical finish.

10. readback

Turn 20. The readback verifies the agreed location, duration, owner, scope, and dependent admission time before circulation.

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06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement correctly separates responsibilities?

D. Ren updates and sends; Asha confirms affected-team acknowledgement.

The brief assigns preparation and distribution to Ren and acknowledgement follow-up to Asha.

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F2. What is the best response to a later timing change?

D. Review its effects with the relevant teams and issue an acknowledged update.

Changes can affect dependencies and must reach the teams expected to act on them.

Return to the exercise, page 72

F / Guided speaking

1. 30

Planner: The test lasts 30 minutes.

Turn 1. The interval from 09:20 to 09:50 is thirty minutes.

2. 10

Coordinator: The buffer before doors is 10 minutes.

Turn 2. Ten minutes separate the 09:50 finish from 10:00 admission.

3. Jo

Planner: The named task owner is Jo.

Turn 3. The brief explicitly assigns responsibility to audio lead Jo.

4. acknowledgement

Coordinator: After circulation, collect team acknowledgement.

Turn 4. Sending the schedule alone does not confirm the affected teams received it.

Return to the conversation, page 73

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "I will ask the affected teams to confirm receipt. Sending the revised version is necessary, but we need to know they have actually seen the change." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "If Vera later needs more time, should she simply edit the finish in the shared document, or contact us before changing the schedule?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Thank you. Their acknowledgement closes the communication step. If someone raises a conflict, we should resolve it explicitly rather than interpret silence as acceptance of every detail.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Asha says: "To confirm: Room A, ten thirty to eleven, Vera responsible, microphone and playback checked, then a fifteen-minute buffer before audience admission." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Asha says: "A presenter asked whether playback was included. They were worried that the microphone might be checked while the recorded material was left until the session itself." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Asha says: "The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Ren's response in turn 14. It connects Asha's preceding point with Asha's follow-up. Acknowledgement confirms that the update reached the relevant teams; sending it alone does not establish that shared awareness.

Return to the exercise, page 73

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is the current operational status?

C. Departure is on hold under the operator's plan.

The operator's hold is active; no restart, route, or cancellation is confirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 76

A2. What should the group do now in this case?

B. Remain in the designated indoor lounge under the current plan.

The supplied local plan keeps the group in its designated indoor waiting location.

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A3. Who makes the operational decision?

D. Operations lead Ben

The brief assigns the decision to Ben and does not give Camila departure-clearance authority.

Return to the exercise, page 76

D / Response choices

D1. Which announcement is accurate?

D. Departure remains on hold; the next operator update is at 09:30.

The announcement preserves the active hold and correctly labels the scheduled communication.

Return to the exercise, page 80

D2. What should Camila do if guests demand an immediate departure?

A. Repeat the active instruction and refer the decision through the operator's process.

Guest pressure does not give the agent authority to override the active operational hold.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Authorized permission to proceed under the relevant process. Which term fits?

A. operational clearance

A Correct. operational clearance: Authorized permission to proceed under the relevant process. The usual combination is "await operational clearance".

B Not here. meeting point: The specified place where a group is to assemble. The usual combination is "confirm the meeting point".

C Not here. designated shelter: A specifically identified protective location in the local plan. The usual combination is "use the designated shelter".

D Not here. cancellation notice: A message confirming that a planned service will not operate. The usual combination is "issue a cancellation notice".

Return to the exercise, page 80

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A weather update is not permission to depart". Mr Ellis: "The sky looks brighter. Could the driver take us out now and avoid the worst part of the coast?" Camila: [missing response] Mr Ellis: "Has the operator canceled it, or are they still deciding? My family heard both versions in the lobby." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. We need operational clearance, not a judgment based on a brighter patch of sky. Our operations lead, Ben, is responsible for the decision. I cannot clear departure myself.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Mr Ellis says: "Has the operator canceled it, or are they still deciding? My family heard both versions in the lobby." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Camila's response in turn 6. It connects Mr Ellis's preceding point with Mr Ellis's follow-up. Operational clearance must come through the authorized operator process; a change in appearance or an improvised route does not provide it.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Mr Ellis says: "Somebody mentioned nine thirty. Is that our new departure time? Should we get our bags ready outside?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Mr Ellis says: "Understood. We will remain here and wait for the operator's message. Please include us even if the next announcement only says the hold continues." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 80

E / Conversation

1. departure hold

Turn 2. The departure hold is the active restriction on leaving, so guests should not interpret the update time as permission to board.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. travel disruption

Turn 4. Travel disruption describes the effect on the guest's plans without implying that a restart or remedy is already confirmed.

3. operational clearance

Turn 6. Operational clearance must come through the authorized operator process; a change in appearance or an improvised route does not provide it.

4. route assessment

Turn 8. The route assessment concerns whether and how the excursion can operate; no route outcome has yet been confirmed.

5. status update

Turn 10. The status update must be passed on even if it only confirms that the existing hold continues.

6. refund eligibility

Turn 12. Refund eligibility depends on the applicable conditions and decision; the case does not establish an approved refund.

7. rebooking

Turn 14. Rebooking changes the reservation and would require a confirmed option and the guest's agreement, not an automatic assumption.

8. indoor waiting area

Turn 16. The designated indoor waiting area is the location specified by the current local plan, keeping guests available for the authorized update.

9. all-clear

Turn 18. An all-clear would require authorized instructions ending the restriction; none has been issued merely because an update is scheduled.

10. communication chain

Turn 20. The communication chain carries the operations lead's authorized status through the tour desk to the guests without inventing an intermediate decision.

Return to the conversation, page 82

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement about cancellation is supported?

A. It has not been confirmed.

The brief distinguishes the current hold from an undecided cancellation.

Return to the exercise, page 85

F2. Which financial statement fits the facts?

B. Refund eligibility and any remedy still require confirmation.

No refund decision or alternative arrangement has been approved in the case.

Return to the exercise, page 85

F / Guided speaking

1. departure

Guest: Does eleven mean departure?

Turn 1. The guest is asking about leaving, which has not been authorized.

2. update

Agent: No; eleven is the next update.

Turn 2. The scheduled time refers only to the operator's communication.

3. lounge

Guest: We should remain in the designated indoor lounge.

Turn 3. The current local plan keeps the group in that location.

4. hold

Agent: Correct; the operational hold remains active.

Turn 4. No authorized decision has ended the restriction on departure.

Return to the conversation, page 86

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A weather update is not permission to depart". Mr Ellis: "Please check with us before moving the booking. An afternoon replacement might clash with our other activity, even if it sounds similar." Camila: [missing response] Mr Ellis: "Where should our group wait so that we do not miss the announcement?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Of course. Any rebooking would need a confirmed option and your agreement. I will explain the actual itinerary and relevant terms if an alternative becomes available, rather than treating it as already arranged.

A Correct. This is Camila's response in turn 14. It connects Mr Ellis's preceding point with Mr Ellis's follow-up. Rebooking changes the reservation and would require a confirmed option and the guest's agreement, not an automatic assumption.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Mr Ellis says: "Has the operator canceled it, or are they still deciding? My family heard both versions in the lobby." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Mr Ellis says: "Will we hear from you at nine thirty even without a decision, or should we keep asking at the desk?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Mr Ellis says: "Thank you for making that clear. I am worried about losing the whole day, especially because we booked another activity later this afternoon." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 86

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What does Ms Rahman want before 14:00 today?

A. No routine room entry

Her stated preference concerns routine entry before a specific time today.

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A2. What is the status of afternoon service?

D. Requested but not yet confirmed

The afternoon team has not confirmed a slot, so the request remains pending.

Return to the exercise, page 87

A3. What is known about later days?

C. No preference has been stated.

The brief explicitly limits the stated preference to today, not the entire stay.

Return to the exercise, page 87

D / Response choices

D1. Which note is accurate?

D. No routine entry before 14:00 today; later service requested, slot pending.

The correct note preserves the guest's stated scope and the unconfirmed afternoon availability.

Return to the exercise, page 91

D2. Which question avoids stereotyping?

B. Would you prefer service later today or no service today?

The neutral question asks about the individual's service choice rather than a presumed group trait.

Return to the exercise, page 91

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Housekeeping provided while a guest continues a stay. Which term fits?

D. stayover service

A Not here. individual variation: Differences among people within the same group. The usual combination is "recognize individual variation".

B Not here. personal space: The distance or privacy a person prefers in an interaction. The usual combination is "respect personal space".

C Not here. opt in: Choose to receive a specified optional service. The usual combination is "opt in to service".

D Correct. stayover service: Housekeeping provided while a guest continues a stay. The usual combination is "coordinate stayover service".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule". Nico: "I also need to correct our earlier note. It says you declined housekeeping for all three nights. Is that what you intended?" Ms Rahman: [missing response] Nico: "I am sorry; that note went beyond what you asked. I will correct it to today's request only." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. No, not for the whole stay. I only declined this morning. Please do not cancel the other days because of that.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Nico says: "I will. I have recorded the request, but I still need their answer before I can say it is arranged." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ms Rahman's response in turn 6. It connects Nico's preceding point with Nico's follow-up. The whole stay covers all three nights, whereas the guest has only stated today's timing preference.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Nico says: "It does. This covers ordinary housekeeping visits; the hotel's separate emergency procedures are unchanged." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Nico says: "To confirm today's request: no routine visit before two, housekeeping afterward if available, and no change requested for the remaining days." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 91

E / Conversation

1. privacy

Turn 2. Privacy concerns the guest's request not to be interrupted before two today, not a whole-stay cancellation.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. afternoon slot

Turn 4. An afternoon slot is the requested later housekeeping allocation; the team has not yet confirmed it.

3. whole stay

Turn 6. The whole stay covers all three nights, whereas the guest has only stated today's timing preference.

4. assumption

Turn 8. An assumption substitutes an unverified group-based belief for this particular guest's stated request.

5. preference

Turn 10. The preference is the individual's choice for today, not a permanent choice determined by nationality.

6. housekeeping note

Turn 12. The housekeeping note carries the practical request to the team and must not imply cancellation of all service.

7. routine service

Turn 14. Routine service means ordinary housekeeping, distinct from entry governed by a separate urgent-situation procedure.

8. confirmation

Turn 16. Confirmation establishes the arrangement after availability is checked; entering a request does not provide it.

9. time window

Turn 18. The time window is the period for service; tomorrow's period has not been requested or agreed.

10. factual

Turn 20. Factual describes a note limited to the stated service request, without cultural explanations or invented future preferences.

Return to the conversation, page 93

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What needs confirmation before promising afternoon service?

A. An available slot from the afternoon team

The requested time depends on staffing availability that has not yet been checked.

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F2. Which statement about future days is supported?

B. Their service preference remains unstated.

The guest has only specified today's preference, so later days cannot be inferred.

Return to the exercise, page 95

F / Guided speaking

1. 15:00

Agent: The no-entry boundary is before 15:00 today.

Turn 1. The guest supplied fifteen hundred as today's routine-entry boundary.

2. availability

Guest: Later service is subject to availability.

Turn 2. The team has not yet confirmed that a suitable later slot exists.

3. unstated

Agent: Tomorrow's preference remains unstated.

Turn 3. No request has been supplied for the following day.

4. stereotype

Guest: Please record my individual request without a cultural stereotype.

Turn 4. A nationality-based generalization is not evidence of this guest's service preference.

Return to the conversation, page 96

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule". Nico: "It does. This covers ordinary housekeeping visits; the hotel's separate emergency procedures are unchanged." Ms Rahman: [missing response] Nico: "I will. I have recorded the request, but I still need their answer before I can say it is arranged." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Understood. I am asking about routine service, not emergencies. Please let me know if the afternoon team cannot fit me in.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Nico says: "I also need to correct our earlier note. It says you declined housekeeping for all three nights. Is that what you intended?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ms Rahman's response in turn 14. It connects Nico's preceding point with Nico's follow-up. Routine service means ordinary housekeeping, distinct from entry governed by a separate urgent-situation procedure.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Nico says: "To confirm today's request: no routine visit before two, housekeeping afterward if available, and no change requested for the remaining days." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Nico says: "I will. I have recorded the request, but I still need their answer before I can say it is arranged." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 96

Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A message documenting a booking and its stated terms. Which term fits?

C. reservation confirmation

A Not here. room release: Authorization to make a prepared room available for use. The usual combination is "await room release".

B Not here. guest relations: The function handling guest experience and concerns. The usual combination is "refer to guest relations".

C Correct. reservation confirmation: A message documenting a booking and its stated terms. The usual combination is "review the reservation confirmation".

D Not here. expectation gap: A difference between anticipated and actual service. The usual combination is "acknowledge an expectation gap".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Criticism directed at the person rather than the issue. Which term fits?

C. personal attack

A Not here. public reply: A response visible to other readers of a review. The usual combination is "publish a public reply".

B Not here. conditional offer: An offer dependent on a stated condition. The usual combination is "reject an improper conditional offer".

C Correct. personal attack: Criticism directed at the person rather than the issue. The usual combination is "avoid personal attacks".

D Not here. case record: The controlled account of a complaint and its handling. The usual combination is "update the case record".

Return to the exercise, page 26

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "An early-arrival request sounded like a promise". Ms Vega: "Please store the bags. I still need to decide whether to get something to eat nearby. How will I know whether anything has changed?" Arun: [missing response] Ms Vega: "All right. I will stay in the lobby until then. Please do not send me to several departments to ask the same question again." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will give you a personal status update at one o'clock. That update will happen even if we are still waiting. One o'clock is not a confirmed time for entering the room.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ms Vega says: "All right. I will stay in the lobby until then. Please do not send me to several departments to ask the same question again." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 10. It connects Ms Vega's preceding point with Ms Vega's follow-up. A status update communicates the current position; it is the action Arun can reliably commit to at thirteen hundred.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ms Vega says: "Another hotel promised twenty minutes, and I waited nearly two hours. I would prefer an honest answer to another guess." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Ms Vega says: "Is there no possibility of a room before three? Should I leave and return later?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 26

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "The public version now thanks the guest for raising the noise concern, acknowledges the disappointing experience, and directs them to the published contact route for follow-up." Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "I will check the records before reaching a conclusion, then communicate any authorized outcome directly. The guest will remain free to leave the review as it is." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That is suitable. After publishing, create the case record and identify yourself as the contact. Preserve the distinction between the public acknowledgement and the unfinished private investigation.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Elise says: "Could you check my response to the noise review before I publish it? I was frustrated by the guest's description." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Elise says: "I will take that sentence out. Could you check the new wording after I remove the booking details as well?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Mateo's response in turn 18. It connects Elise's preceding point with Elise's follow-up. The case record should track responsibility, relevant facts, and actions so the private review does not lose continuity.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Elise says: "Understood. I will not promise compensation in the initial reply either. We still need to check the facts and determine what our policy permits." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 26

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A room with two separate beds. Which term fits?

D. twin room

A Not here. relocation: Moving a booking or guest to another property. The usual combination is "explain the relocation".

B Not here. rate difference: The difference between the two room prices. The usual combination is "cover the rate difference".

C Not here. confirmation number: An identifier for a confirmed booking. The usual combination is "verify the confirmation number".

D Correct. twin room: A room with two separate beds. The usual combination is "offer a twin room".

Return to the exercise, page 51

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Revenue from services other than room sales. Which term fits?

B. non-room revenue

A Not here. net room revenue: Room revenue after the specified deductions. The usual combination is "define net room revenue".

B Correct. non-room revenue: Revenue from services other than room sales. The usual combination is "separate non-room revenue".

C Not here. pickup: The change in booked business between reporting points. The usual combination is "report booking pickup".

D Not here. average daily rate (ADR): Room revenue divided by rooms sold for the period. The usual combination is "calculate average daily rate".

Return to the exercise, page 51

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A public reply should not become a public argument". Elise: "I will take that sentence out. Could you check the new wording after I remove the booking details as well?" Mateo: [missing response] Elise: "I can handle the follow-up. Once the guest contacts us privately, I will confirm the necessary booking information through our approved process and review the available records." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Exactly. That defensive tone makes a factual conversation harder. We can explain relevant verified information later, but first we need a proper review and a clear person responsible.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Elise says: "Understood. I will not promise compensation in the initial reply either. We still need to check the facts and determine what our policy permits." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Elise says: "Could you check my response to the noise review before I publish it? I was frustrated by the guest's description." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Mateo's response in turn 10. It connects Elise's preceding point with Elise's follow-up. A defensive tone shifts attention from helping with the complaint to protecting the property from criticism.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Elise says: "I included the room number and stay dates to show that we know the booking. I also said the guest exaggerated what happened that night." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 2 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "Then the next discussion should look at context rather than force a cause into the headline. Which breakdown would make that review more useful?" Mina: [missing response] Owen: "I will revise the summary to say that ADR increased while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue declined. That is less sweeping and more informative." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Examine market segments and channel mix, alongside demand and booking pace. Keep the same period and definitions, and include relevant costs before making a profitability claim.

A Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 18. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Channel mix identifies how sales are distributed across booking routes and can add context to revenue and distribution-cost analysis.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "Our average rate went up on the second night, so I have called it a complete commercial improvement. Is there anything missing from that summary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Owen says: "So the first average is one hundred dollars per sold room, and the second is one hundred and twenty. That is a twenty-percent increase." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Owen says: "I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Confirmation that the required maintenance conditions are satisfied. Which term fits?

D. maintenance clearance

A Not here. vacant dirty: A room-status label indicating cleaning is still required. The usual combination is "report vacant dirty".

B Not here. handover log: A record used to transfer operational responsibility. The usual combination is "update the handover log".

C Not here. release authorization: Permission to make the room available for assignment. The usual combination is "verify release authorization".

D Correct. maintenance clearance: Confirmation that the required maintenance conditions are satisfied. The usual combination is "obtain maintenance clearance".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A list of event signals and related actions. Which term fits?

C. cue sheet

A Not here. room layout: The arrangement of seating, tables, and equipment. The usual combination is "approve the room layout".

B Not here. strike: Removal of event equipment after use. The usual combination is "schedule the strike".

C Correct. cue sheet: A list of event signals and related actions. The usual combination is "verify the cue sheet".

D Not here. run of show: The timed sequence of event activities and responsibilities. The usual combination is "update the run of show".

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Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue". Owen: "That means an eight-dollar reduction per available room. Relative to eighty dollars, it is ten percent lower, despite the higher average selling rate." Mina: [missing response] Owen: "Could we still say that profit improved because we had fewer rooms to service? Fewer occupied rooms might mean some costs were lower." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Yes. Total room revenue also fell ten percent, from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred. The unchanged supply means those two percentage changes align in this comparison.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "Our average rate went up on the second night, so I have called it a complete commercial improvement. Is there anything missing from that summary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Owen says: "I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Owen says: "I will revise the summary to say that ADR increased while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue declined. That is less sweeping and more informative." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 10. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Room revenue fell from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred dollars, the same ten-percent decline with unchanged supply.

Return to the exercise, page 74

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "I will flag eleven fifteen to the admission team. They have an older copy with eleven on it, so we need that copy replaced." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "To confirm: Room A, ten thirty to eleven, Vera responsible, microphone and playback checked, then a fifteen-minute buffer before audience admission." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Doors open remains eleven fifteen. Keep that separate from setup and testing times, even though all three activities occur in the same room sequence.

A Correct. This is Ren's response in turn 18. It connects Asha's preceding point with Asha's follow-up. Doors open identifies the audience-admission time, which is eleven fifteen rather than the eleven o'clock technical finish.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Asha says: "The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Asha says: "I will ask the affected teams to confirm receipt. Sending the revised version is necessary, but we need to know they have actually seen the change." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Asha says: "Agreed. I have checked Room A, and the available slot is ten thirty until eleven. Does that fit the equipment and audio lead?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 74

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A temporary restriction preventing the tour from leaving. Which term fits?

C. departure hold

A Not here. lightning safety plan: A documented procedure for managing lightning-related activity risk. The usual combination is "follow the lightning safety plan".

B Not here. restart decision: A determination that a suspended activity may resume. The usual combination is "communicate the restart decision".

C Correct. departure hold: A temporary restriction preventing the tour from leaving. The usual combination is "maintain the departure hold".

D Not here. group accountability: Knowing where the members of a group are. The usual combination is "maintain group accountability".

Return to the exercise, page 97

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Choose not to receive a specified optional service. Which term fits?

A. opt out

A Correct. opt out: Choose not to receive a specified optional service. The usual combination is "opt out for today".

B Not here. assumed preference: A choice attributed to someone without confirmation. The usual combination is "question an assumed preference".

C Not here. language preference: The language a person chooses for communication. The usual combination is "check language preference".

D Not here. service preference: An individual's stated choice about how service is provided. The usual combination is "clarify a service preference".

Return to the exercise, page 97

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked". Asha: "A presenter asked whether playback was included. They were worried that the microphone might be checked while the recorded material was left until the session itself." Ren: [missing response] Asha: "Which document should people use? There is an old planning email, my event schedule, and a venue copy with the vague audio note." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The playback feed is part of Vera's confirmed scope. I will put both items in the entry so the presenter and audio team can see the same expectation.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Asha says: "The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Asha says: "To confirm: Room A, ten thirty to eleven, Vera responsible, microphone and playback checked, then a fifteen-minute buffer before audience admission." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Ren's response in turn 10. It connects Asha's preceding point with Asha's follow-up. The playback feed is explicitly included alongside the event microphone in Vera's soundcheck scope.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Asha says: "My team expected the venue to arrange the soundcheck. Your schedule just says audio before doors. Do we have a confirmed room and time anywhere?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 97

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule". Nico: "Certainly. We can check tomorrow's arrangements separately when you know what you would like." Ms Rahman: [missing response] Nico: "To confirm today's request: no routine visit before two, housekeeping afterward if available, and no change requested for the remaining days." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That suits me. I may want a different time window tomorrow, but I have not decided. Please leave tomorrow's timing open for now.

A Correct. This is Ms Rahman's response in turn 18. It connects Nico's preceding point with Nico's follow-up. The time window is the period for service; tomorrow's period has not been requested or agreed.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Nico says: "I am sorry; that note went beyond what you asked. I will correct it to today's request only." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Nico says: "You are right. We should have asked you directly. I will keep the note about the service and timing, not your nationality." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Nico says: "Certainly. I will ask the afternoon team what they can arrange, then come back to you with an available time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 97

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. authorization hold

Turn 2. An authorization hold reserves funds or credit temporarily; its pending display is not proof of a second completed payment.

2. itemized folio

Turn 6. The itemized folio lists the room, tax, and parking charges, allowing the guest to reconcile the $280 total.

3. settled payment

Turn 10. The settled payment is the completed $280 checkout transaction in the supplied record, not the sum of a posted payment and pending authorization.

4. release request

Turn 12. The release request is the hotel's instruction concerning unused authorization; it does not confirm when the issuer will update available funds or its display.

5. card issuer

Turn 16. The card issuer maintains the card account and can check how the pending authorization affects it; the hotel cannot promise its processing time.

6. available balance

Turn 20. The available balance reflects what the guest can currently use; it can be affected by a hold even when only one payment has settled.

Return to the conversation, page 100

Transfer exchange

1. 180

Guest: The final itemized bill is 180 dollars.

Turn 1. The supplied folio and posted payment both total one hundred eighty dollars.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. pending

Agent: The separate authorization is still labeled pending.

Turn 2. The banking display identifies the authorization as pending, not another posted payment.

3. refund

Guest: The forty-dollar difference is not automatically a cash refund.

Turn 3. An unused authorization is released rather than refunded as though it were a completed charge.

4. timing

Agent: The issuer must confirm the release timing.

Turn 4. The hotel has submitted the request but cannot guarantee the issuer's processing time.

Return to the conversation, page 103

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. specific features

Turn 2. Specific features identify what this guest needs; a general accessible label does not establish the bed or bathing arrangement.

2. roll-in shower

Turn 6. The roll-in shower is the verified bathing feature in Room C; a tub with grab bars is not the requested substitute.

3. layout

Turn 10. The layout shows the arrangement of the bathroom features, helping the guest assess suitability without the agent asking for a diagnosis.

4. access needs

Turn 12. Access needs concern the practical features the guest requires, not a presumed limitation based on a broad disability label.

5. reservation

Turn 16. The reservation is the actual booking, distinct from an availability discussion; it will be completed after the requested details and the guest's decision.

6. bed configuration

Turn 20. The bed configuration is two separate queen beds in Room C, which must be preserved together with the requested shower features.

Return to the conversation, page 105

Transfer exchange

1. 3

Agent: The verified feature match is Room 3.

Turn 1. Only Room 3 combines both the requested bed arrangement and shower type.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. combination

Guest: Two beds with a tub are not an equivalent combination.

Turn 2. Room 2 meets the bed requirement but fails the separately stated shower requirement.

3. route

Agent: The remaining information concerns the route.

Turn 3. The brief identifies route information as the detail still requiring verification.

4. reservation

Guest: Availability alone does not complete my reservation.

Turn 4. The guest has not yet decided or completed a booking in this scenario.

Return to the conversation, page 107

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. master account

Turn 2. The master account is the organizer's group billing account; the agreement permits room and tax there, not every guest charge.

2. individual folio

Turn 6. The individual folio should carry the guest's $20 parking and $30 breakfast charges, totaling $50 in this supplied example.

3. routing instructions

Turn 10. Routing instructions define which charge categories go to which account; existing postings also need checking rather than assuming an edit moves them correctly.

4. audit trail

Turn 12. The audit trail records the original postings and authorized transfers, so the corrected payer split remains explainable without deleting charges.

5. billing dispute

Turn 16. A billing dispute records disagreement about who should pay or what is due; it should be reviewed without presenting unverified approval as fact.

6. charge transfer

Turn 20. The charge transfer moves the $50 extras to the proper unpaid guest folio while preserving the $380 total and the recorded history.

Return to the conversation, page 109

Transfer exchange

1. 264

Coordinator: The organizer pays 264 dollars.

Turn 1. Two room nights total $240 and two tax amounts total $24, producing $264.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. 18

Cashier: The guest pays 18 dollars.

Turn 2. The supplied parking total belongs to the guest under the stated agreement.

3. 282

Coordinator: The combined bill remains 282 dollars.

Turn 3. Adding the organizer's $264 and the guest's $18 preserves the $282 total.

4. refund

Cashier: Changing the unpaid allocation is not a refund.

Turn 4. No payment has settled, so correcting the payer allocation does not return money already paid.

Return to the conversation, page 112

Find a phrase by purpose

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge the impact: I understand that you planned around arriving at noon.

Own unclear wording: I am sorry the confirmation did not make that distinction clear.

Clarify the record: The message records your request for early access.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Recognize the concern: Thank you for raising your concern about the noise.

Acknowledge disappointment: I am sorry to hear that your stay was disappointing.

Avoid a premature finding: We would like to review the details with you.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

State the problem directly: Your booked king-room type is unavailable tonight.

Acknowledge responsibility: I am sorry we cannot provide the room type you reserved.

Introduce choices: I have two verified alternatives to explain.

Full phrase bank, page 31

Revenue Management and Pricing

Clarify the headline: Which measure do we mean by improved?

State the common base: Both nights had 100 available rooms.

Give the first result: Night A sold 80 rooms for $8,000.

Full phrase bank, page 42

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Name the exact room: I am checking the release status for Room 417.

Separate department checks: Housekeeping is cleared, but maintenance is not.

Identify the open item: The door-lock repair remains open.

Full phrase bank, page 56

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Expose the assumption: We both assumed the other team had arranged it.

Name the missing details: The schedule lacks a time, room, and owner.

Confirm the slot: Room A is available from 10:30 to 11:00.

Full phrase bank, page 67

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

State the hold first: Departure is currently on hold.

Explain the present action: Please remain in the designated indoor lounge.

Name the responsible authority: Our operations lead is reviewing the conditions.

Full phrase bank, page 79

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Ask about the service: Would you prefer service later today or no service today?

Confirm the time boundary: You would like no routine entry before 14:00 today.

Clarify the requested option: You would like housekeeping after 14:00 if available.

Full phrase bank, page 90

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] CoStar / STR. What Is Hotel Benchmarking?

Background definitions for occupancy, average daily rate, and revenue per available room. The two-day pricing comparison and all figures are original teaching examples. Source checked 30 September 2026.

https://www.costar.com/products/benchmark/resources/data-insights-blog/what-hotel-benchmarking

[2] Google Business Profile Help. Tips to Get More Reviews.

Background on professional public replies, privacy, and the prohibition on incentives to change or remove reviews. The complaint dialogue and property policy are fictional. Source checked 30 September 2026.

https://support.google.com/business/answer/3474122

[3] National Weather Service. Lightning Safety and Outdoor Sports Activities.

Background on planned weather decisions and designated responsibility for outdoor activities. The tour case supplies a fictional local hold and guest-update process, not a complete safety plan. Source checked 30 September 2026.

https://www.weather.gov/safety/lightning-sports

> **Companion course**
>
> The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.
>
> https://englishladder.com/efsp-hospitality-tourism.html

Welcome warmly. Resolve clearly. Coordinate precisely.

Eight service conversations: welcome an early arrival, answer a complaint, offer accommodation alternatives, explain room revenue, coordinate a room release, confirm an event schedule, update a disrupted tour, and clarify an individual preference.

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

The recorded request is not a confirmed noon check-in. The 13:00 update is a communication commitment, not a room-release estimate. Standard check-in begins at 15:00; Arun should not invent a different guaranteed time.

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

An acknowledgement is not a finding that every allegation is correct. Equally, missing verification is not proof that the guest is wrong. The public reply should not announce the result of a review that has not occurred.

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

A twin room does not preserve a king-bed configuration. A king room at another hotel preserves that feature but changes location. Neither alternative should be called identical to the original booking.

Revenue Management and Pricing

Night A: occupancy 80%, ADR $100, RevPAR $80. Night B: occupancy 60%, ADR $120, RevPAR $72. ADR increased 20%, but RevPAR and total room revenue each decreased 10%. Occupancy fell 20 percentage points.

Phil Stilwell

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